

EX-BANKER, FORMER SINGER AMONG SEVEN ARRESTED FOR FAKE CBI RAIDS **P2**



INSULT TO PEOPLE OF T'GANA: CM ON CENTRE'S DENIAL OF US VISIT **P5**

'DHURANDHAR WASN'T AN EASY FILM TO MOUNT' **P14**



ROADS WATERLOGGED, FLIGHTS DIVERTED, POTHOLE TURN HAZARDOUS

Rain brings Delhi-NCR to standstill

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 24

Heavy rain accompanied by thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds disrupted life across Delhi-NCR on Monday, flooding roads, slowing traffic to a crawl and affecting air travel, while Gurugram authorities ordered schools to shift classes online and advised corporate offices to allow employees to work from home on Tuesday. Several parts of Delhi recorded close to 70 mm of rain during the day, while Gurugram also received about 70 mm by early afternoon. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) forecast more rain overnight and issued alerts for the national capital, with winds reaching 30-40 kmph in some areas. The showers provided relief from the humidity but



School buses wade through a waterlogged road following heavy rainfall, at Subhash Chowk in Gurugram, Haryana, on Monday

PTI

quickly left roads, markets and residential areas waterlogged. In Delhi, flooding was reported at New Ashok Nagar Metro station, Burari,

CR Park, Alaknanda, Sangam Vihar, Bhalswa and Sadar Bazar. Kamla Nagar market was also affected, while water accumulated

around Bhairon Marg, ITO, Mathura Road and the inner and outer circles of Connaught Place. Sangam Vihar saw some

KEY POINTS

- » Delhi recorded rainfall nearing 70 mm in several areas
- » Gurugram received 70 mm rain by 1.30 pm
- » School buses and ambulances were stranded across Gurugram
- » Gurugram advised offices to allow work from home Tuesday
- » Delhi airport diverted 15 flights amid bad weather
- » Twelve diverted flights were sent to Jaipur
- » Two flights were diverted to Chandigarh, one to Lucknow

» TWENTY-SIX FLIGHTS WERE CANCELLED AND OVER 400 DELAYED



India heads for weakest monsoon since 2009

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 24

The country is heading towards its weakest monsoon in nearly two decades, with seasonal rainfall likely to end about 15 per cent below the long-term average, two senior weather department officials said. If realised, the June-September monsoon would record its lowest rainfall since 2009. The projected shortfall is almost twice the 8 per cent deficit forecast by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) in

CONTINUED ON P4

Jaishankar, Putin discuss energy, trade and fertiliser

Putin may visit India next month

MPOST BUREAU
Moscow, August 24

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Monday met Russian President Vladimir Putin in Moscow, with the two sides reviewing economic cooperation in trade, energy, fertilisers and nuclear power. Jaishankar is on a two-day visit to Russia ahead of Putin's expected trip to New Delhi for the BRICS Summit next month. Jaishankar said India and Russia had held a meeting of their inter-governmental commission earlier in the day and received a "good report" on economic cooperation. "Overall, I think our economic cooperation has grown very significantly," he said.

Putin said Russia was increasing fertiliser supplies to India and was pre-



KEY POINTS

- » Jaishankar said economic cooperation has grown "very significantly"
- » Russia is increasing fertiliser supplies to meet Indian farmers' needs
- » Putin said India-Russia trade increased this year after declining slightly
- » Putin said cooperation spans governments, parliaments and businesses

pared to continue meeting the requirements of Indian farmers. CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Onion prices up 59%, govt boosts supplies

NEW DELHI: The Centre has begun transporting bulk onion stocks from Nashik in Maharashtra to major consumption centres through dedicated railway rakes, known as the 'Kanda Express', to increase supplies and contain the seasonal rise in prices, Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare said on Monday. The onions currently being loaded are expected to reach the identified destinations by Wednesday. Initially, supplies will be sent to Chennai, Madurai, Delhi, Ernakulam and Guwahati, with more cities to be added depending on market requirements, Khare said. CONTINUED ON P4

No more boarding pass stamps

NEW DELHI: International travellers will be able to use e-boarding passes displayed on their smartphones during immigration clearance at Indian airports from September 1, the Bureau of Immigration (BoI) said on Monday. The move will end the practice of physically stamping boarding passes during immigration checks. In an advisory posted on X, the Ministry of Home Affairs-controlled agency said the change would mean "less paper, fewer steps and smoother travel". The BoI said travellers enrolled under the Fast Track Immigration-Trusted Traveler Program (FTI-TTP) will also be able to use e-boarding passes at immigration e-gates. CONTINUED ON P4

Govt plans to award 11 airports to pvt players under PPP model

Rs 8,622 crore investment expected

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 24

The government is preparing to hand over the operation of 11 Airports Authority of India (AAI) airports to private operators under the public-private partnership (PPP) model, with the facilities grouped into five bundles. Each bundle will be awarded to a single concessionaire for a 50-year concession period. The Civil Aviation Ministry's proposal received in-principle approval from the Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) at its meeting on August 4, according to the minutes of the meeting. The committee is chaired by Economic Affairs Secretary Anuradha Thakur. The proposed bundles pair five major airports with six smaller ones. Amritsar will be grouped with Kangra-Gaggal, while Varanasi will be combined with Gaya and Kushinagar. Bhubaneswar and Hub-

KEY POINTS

- » Varanasi, Tirupati, Amritsar and Bhubaneswar among airports proposed
- » Concession period set at 50 years under the PPP model
- » Private operators expected to invest an estimated Rs 8,622 crore

balli will form another bundle, with Raipur and Aurangabad making up the fourth. Tiruchirappalli and Tirupati will constitute the fifth group.

The total investment expected from the private concessionaires is estimated at Rs 8,622 crore. To limit market concentration and the risks of excessive borrowing by operators, the number of bundles that can be awarded to a single bidder will be capped, the document said. The ministry has also proposed measures to support the transition of existing AAI employees. CONTINUED ON P4

36 RESCUED, PROBE ORDERED

Three infants die in fire at govt hospital in Amravati



Family members and relatives look at the mortal remains of three newborns who died after a fire broke out

PTI

MPOST BUREAU
Amravati (Maharashtra), August 24

Three newborn babies died and 36 others were rescued after a fire broke out in the Neonatal Intensive Care Unit (NICU) of the District Women's Hospital in Amravati early Monday, prompting the Maharashtra government to order a high-level inquiry into the tragedy. The fire started at around 3.15 am in the out-born section of the NICU,

which was treating premature, low-weight and critically ill infants. According to police and health officials, the blaze was triggered by an explosion in a ventilator. The NICU had three sections, including inborn, outborn and a step-down care ward for babies preparing to be discharged. A total of 39 infants were admitted to the unit when the fire broke out. Staff and rescuers managed to evacuate all nine babies from

the affected outborn section, but three infants died in the blaze. Amravati Police Commissioner Rakesh Ola said six rescued babies were shifted to a super-speciality hospital, while four others were moved to the Divisional Referral Services Hospital. One child remains in critical condition. The bodies of the three infants who died have been sent for post-mortem examinations. CONTINUED ON P4

Doval in Beijing for India-China border talks today

MPOST BUREAU
Beijing, August 24

National Security Advisor Ajit Doval arrived in Beijing on Monday for a two-day visit to hold Special Representatives talks with Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on the India-China boundary issue. The talks are scheduled for Tuesday and come ahead of Chinese President Xi Jinping's expected visit to New Delhi

for the BRICS summit on September 12-13. Xi's visit could provide an opportunity for a meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the sidelines of the summit. The two leaders last met in August 2025 during the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Tianjin. Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Lin Jian said Doval and

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 24

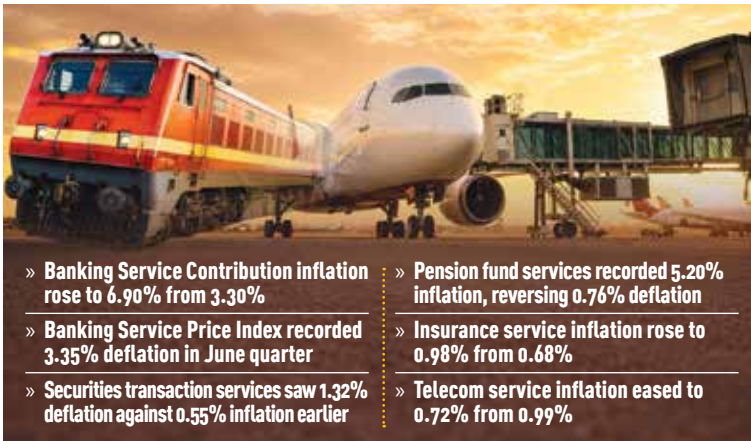
After successfully pushing its NEET protest campaign into the national spotlight, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) is set to hit the streets again on September 5, announcing a march from India Gate to the new Delhi Police Headquarters. The group says it is returning to public protest over what

GOVT PLANS TO EXPAND SERVICE PPI COVERAGE

Air passenger service prices record 32% inflation, railways at 3.5% in June quarter

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 24

Air passenger service prices rose nearly 32 per cent year-on-year in the June quarter, marking the sharpest increase among the seven major services covered in the government's latest Service Producer Price Index (PPI) data released on Monday. The Commerce and Industry Ministry's provisional Service PPI figures for the first quarter of 2026-27 cover banking, securities transactions, insurance, pension fund management, railways, air passenger services and telecom. The indices have 2022-23 as their base year. According to the data, the Air



- » Banking Service Contribution inflation rose to 6.90% from 3.30%
- » Banking Service Price Index recorded 3.35% deflation in June quarter
- » Securities transaction services saw 1.32% deflation against 0.55% inflation earlier

- » Pension fund services recorded 5.20% inflation, reversing 0.76% deflation
- » Insurance service inflation rose to 0.98% from 0.68%
- » Telecom service inflation eased to 0.72% from 0.99%

(Passenger) Service Price Index recorded annual inflation of 31.94 per cent in the June quarter. A sequential comparison is not avail-

able because the price reference period for air passenger services is the 2025-26 financial year. Railway passenger service

prices increased 3.50 per cent annually during the quarter, unchanged from the rate recorded in the March quarter of 2025-26. The banking sector showed mixed movements across the two banking-related measures. Inflation in the Banking Service Contribution sector increased to 6.90 per cent in the June quarter from 3.30 per cent in the previous quarter. At the same time, the Banking Service Price Index recorded deflation of 3.35 per cent, compared with deflation of 4.10 per cent in the March quarter. The Securities Transaction Service Price Index also remained in deflation, with prices declining 1.32 per cent annually against inflation of 0.55 per cent

CONTINUED ON P4

INDIANS MAY FACE IMPACT

US plans to hike H1-B visa fee over \$100,000

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, August 24

The US on Monday proposed a USD 103,265 fee for all H1-B visa cap-subject applications, including those eligible for the advanced degree exemption, the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) said. The new proposal from the DHS came a month after a federal appeals court rejected a plea to stay a district judge's order overturning the Trump administration plan to charge a USD 1,00,000 fee for H1-B visa applications. "...DHS proposes to implement the USD 103,265 amount as a sep-

arate, additional H1-B fee rather than combining it with the existing H1-B petition fee," according to a notice published in the Federal Register. It said the fee would apply only to H1-B cap-subject petitions, including those eligible for the advanced degree exemption, but not to cap-exempt filings. The proposed fee is specifically to recover the interagency costs described in this rule and having a standalone fee is intended to facilitate tracking, allocation, and reporting of the associated revenue, the DHS said. For these reasons, DHS proposes to implement the USD 103,265

CONTINUED ON P4

Ex-banker, former singer among seven arrested for fake CBI raids

Gang staged raids to intimidate targets, extract cash...

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

A former bar and restaurant singer, an ex-banker and a woman who once ran a hotel are among seven people arrested for allegedly posing as CBI officers and carrying out fake raids to intimidate targets and extract money or valuables in Delhi and Mumbai, police said on Monday.

The accused allegedly arrived at a residence in Delhi's Prashant Vihar in black clothing on August 11, flashed purported CBI identity cards and threatened a businessman and his mother with a raid, only to retreat after neighbours intervened and the family questioned their credentials, police said.

The seven arrested have been identified as Asifa (29), a native of Jammu and Kashmir; Pooja Aggarwal, a former singer at bars and restaurants; Kuldeep Sharma (63), a former employee of a bank; Chander Prakash Sharma (38), a former electronics repairman; and unemployed men Shubham alias Golu (25), Rajveer Singh (21), and Nitin Sharma (30). "The case was cracked



IMPOSTOR SQUAD

» The seven arrested have been identified as Asifa (29), a native of Jammu and Kashmir; Pooja Aggarwal, a former singer at bars and restaurants; Kuldeep Sharma (63), a former employee of a bank; Chander Prakash Sharma (38), a former electronics repairman; and unemployed men Shubham alias Golu (25), Rajveer Singh (21), Nitin Sharma (30)

» The accused allegedly arrived at a residence in Delhi's Prashant Vihar in black clothing on August 11, flashed purported CBI identity cards and threatened a businessman...

through analysis of CCTV footage, electronic evidence, technical surveillance and a purported CBI notice sent to the complainant's father," Deputy Commissioner of Police (Rohini) Shashank Jaiswal said.

According to the police, the incident occurred at 10 pm on August 11 when businessman Pratham Aggarwal and his mother were at their home in Prashant Vihar. A group of around eight people, including six men and two women, reached the residence and introduced themselves as CBI officials.

They allegedly displayed identity cards and said they had come to conduct a raid. When Aggarwal and his mother asked

them to show proper authorisation or a search warrant, the group threatened and intimidated them, the officer said.

The suspects remained outside the house for around 90 minutes, creating panic. When neighbours intervened, they allegedly claimed that a notice had been issued to Aggarwal's father and left saying they would retrieve it from their vehicle. The family subsequently contacted the police helpline.

"A fake CBI notice was also sent to Aggarwal's father on his mobile phone. Though the original message was later deleted, the family had retained a screenshot, which became part of the investigation," the officer said.

Police said an FIR was registered at Prashant Vihar police station on August 19 under sections 308(2) (extortion), 351(2) (criminal intimidation) and 61(2) (criminal conspiracy) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Police subsequently examined CCTV footage and digital material and traced the alleged network behind the incident.

Police said Asifa and Pooja allegedly gathered information on targets, while Chander arranged people for fake raids. Clothing bearing a CBI monogram and fake ID images were recovered. Videos suggest the group may have posed as CBI, ED and other officials in Delhi and Mumbai.

5 held for abducting, thrashing 18-year-old over girl's complaint

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

A complaint by a woman about a former colleague allegedly speaking against her triggered a late-night confrontation that ended with an 18-year-old man being dragged into a car, beaten and taken to a park, where he was allegedly assaulted again, police said on Monday. Five men, aged between 19 and 23, have been apprehended in connection with the incident in north Delhi's Kamla Nagar and Gulabi Bagh areas, they said.

The incident took place around 11 pm on Sunday when Vishesh was sitting with his childhood friend Deepak near a shop in Kamla Nagar.

The accused arrived in a Maruti Ertiga car, allegedly assaulted Vishesh and forcibly dragged him into the vehicle, police said.

"A PCR call regarding the abduction was received at Roop Nagar police station, following which a team rushed to the spot and alerted police personnel deployed on patrol and picket duty," a senior police officer said.

The police traced the victim's location to Gulabi Bagh and rushed there. The team heard cries and

ACCUSED ARRIVED IN A CAR, ASSAULTED VISHESH AND FORCIBLY DRAGGED HIM INTO THE VEHICLE

shouting from a park and found Vishesh with the five accused, police said.

All five were apprehended within two hours of the PCR call.

"The accused have been identified as Shubham (19), Swayam Shah (21), Tanmay (20), Rishi (23), and Dhruv (23). Police seized the Ertiga allegedly used in the crime. The vehicle is registered in the name of Swayam's mother," the officer said. According to the police, the victim suffered serious injuries, including a head injury.

Police said the assault stemmed from a woman's complaint that Vishesh, her former colleague, had spoken inappropriately about her. Shubham and Swayam allegedly confronted Vishesh in Kamla Nagar, where they, along with Dhruv, Tanmay and Rishi, assaulted him. The accused then allegedly abducted him, assaulted him with sticks and took him to Gulabi Bagh park.

DU's 4-year degree faces 1st major test

Research opportunity or extra year?

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 24

Delhi University's four-year undergraduate programme (FYUP), introduced under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, is entering a crucial phase as its first cohort completes the programme, with the university defending the additional year as a pathway to research while concerns persist over participation, infrastructure and its relevance to students.

Of the 75,948 students admitted to the first FYUP batch in 2022-23, 40,005 exited after three years in 2025, while 35,943 continued into the fourth year. The university says the optional year is designed to strengthen research, entrepreneurship, internships and practical learning.

The fourth year has also opened new academic routes. DU offered 5,857 seats across 46 one-year postgraduate programmes for 2026-27. Of the 35,943 students continuing into the fourth year, 12,111 applied for these programmes.

DU has further



approved direct PhD admission for FYUP graduates with a CGPA of 7.5 or above, or 7 for SC/ST students. For 2026-27, it will conduct an in-house entrance test as a special measure.

The model, however, has its critics. Faculty concerns include low participation, the viability of specialised fourth-year classes, infrastructure and faculty capacity. Student discussions have similarly reflected mixed experiences: some see the year as an opportunity for research, minors and specialised skills, while others prefer entering employment or preparing for competitive examinations.

The central question is therefore not merely whether FYUP adds a year, but whether DU can make that year academically valuable enough to justify the additional time and resources.

ABVP launches 'My DU, My Manifesto'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) Delhi has launched the 'My DU, My Manifesto' campaign ahead of the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections on September 18, inviting students to share concerns, expectations and suggestions for inclusion in its upcoming manifesto.

Students can submit their views through a QR code and ABVP volunteers campaigning across college campuses. The organisation said the manifesto should reflect students' needs rather than be framed solely by student groups. ABVP Delhi State Secretary Sarthak Sharma said the campaign aims to gather student priorities and convert suggestions into practical, student-centric proposals. Vote counting is scheduled for September 19.

Car rams vehicles & runs over couple; woman dies

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 24

A 71-year-old woman was killed and her husband critically injured after a car allegedly hit several vehicles and ran over the couple near Kailash Colony Metro Station in south Delhi's Greater Kailash-1 on Sunday, police said.

The woman, Shashi, and her 65-year-old husband, Kulbhushan, were taken to Moolchand Hospital, where Shashi was declared dead. Kulbhushan was treated and later discharged to record his statement.

Police said the accused, identified as 59-year-old Tapan Ahir, allegedly lost control of a Mahindra XEV 9e, hitting a Mahindra Thar, an autorickshaw and a cycle rickshaw before striking the couple. Ahir, a driver employed by the vehicle's owner since 1997,



ACCUSED, IDENTIFIED AS 59-YEAR-OLD TAPAN AHIR, ALLEGEDLY LOST CONTROL OF HIS MAHINDRA CAR...

was reportedly on his way to pick up his brother from Kailash Colony Market.

A case has been registered under sections 281, 125(a) and 106 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police have sent Ahir's blood sample to the FSL to determine whether he was driving under the influence of alcohol. The exact sequence of events is being investigated.

IIT-Delhi classes suspended amid protest over student's 'suicide'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

Classes at IIT-Delhi were suspended on Monday amid student protests following the alleged suicide of a 31-year-old MSc Physics student, officials said.

Protesters demanded an independent probe into alleged administrative lapses, accountability and improved student support systems.

They also sought senior officials' resignations, Rs 1-crore compensation for the family, protection from disciplinary action and greater transparency over mental-health protocols.

IIT-Delhi Director Rangan Banerjee met protesters, who said some demands had received a positive response, while others remained unresolved.

6 nabbed after fake 'Bretish Airways' job racket exposed

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

Six people, including the alleged mastermind, a website developer and three tele-callers, have been arrested for allegedly running a fake airline job racket, police said on Monday.

The accused allegedly lured job seekers through social media advertisements, promising airport jobs after they paid Rs 7,000 to Rs 10,000 for a purported aviation diploma. The racket surfaced after a man was contacted by a woman posing as an HR executive for fake "British Airways". He paid Rs 7,000 and received fake admission and job documents.

Police traced the suspects to Noida and arrested alleged mastermind Sandeep Kumar, 23, and associate Akhil Kumar, 27,

THE ACCUSED LATER LAUNCHED WEBSITES UNDER "SHANKH AIRWAYS" & "EXCELLENCE LEARNING INSTITUTE". DELHI POLICE ARRESTED WEBSITE DEVELOPER RAKESH KUMAR...

on August 18. They allegedly ran fake companies from a rented office, using websites, purchased job-seeker data and women tele-callers posing as HR executives.

The accused later allegedly launched websites under "Shankh Airways" and "Excellence Learning Institute". Police arrested website developer Rakesh Kumar, 47, and tele-callers Shweta, Sapna and Sakshi, 20.

Police seized laptops, phones, SIM cards and job-seeker data. NCRP scrutiny revealed 10 linked complaints. Further investigation is underway.

In a separate case, Delhi Police busted a sham call

centre in Laxmi Nagar and arrested three people, including two women, for allegedly duping job seekers with fake airline job offers. The accused allegedly posed as HR representatives and demanded money through UPI for registration and employment-related charges. Police identified the accused as Mohammad Zaid, Sadaf and Tanisha. The case came to light after a Chhat-tisgarh resident reported losing Rs 14,500 to a fake job offer. Police traced the money trail to Zaid before arresting the trio. Two other NCRP complaints have also been linked to mobile numbers allegedly used by the accused.

Briefs

L-G reviews Narela security

NEW DELHI: Delhi L-G TS Sandhu on Monday directed the Delhi Police to enhance its presence and security in the fast-developing Narela area and asked the MCD to ensure adequate civic amenities.

The directions came during a coordination meeting with the Home Department, Delhi Fire Service, Delhi Police, DDA and MCD on parking, encroachments, fire preparedness and other inter-agency issues. Sandhu urged agencies to coordinate closely, strengthen school outreach and POCOS awareness, operationalise unused parking sites, develop multi-level parking and complete vendor surveys.

Woman killed, body dumped in canal in Noida

NOIDA: A woman living with her partner in Mamura, Sector 66, was allegedly strangled to death following a dispute over suspicion of an affair, police said Monday. Three people, including her partner, have been arrested.

Police said Subhash Chandra allegedly killed the woman on July 27 before calling his cousin Sarvendra and cousin-in-law Neeraj. The trio allegedly dumped the body in a canal near Kot village in Dabri.

The case surfaced after Subhash allegedly threatened his wife, who alerted police and suspected he had killed the woman. Police later linked him to an unidentified body.

HOSPITALS TOLD TO STEP UP MONITORING Cabinet likely to discuss rise in H1N1 cases

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 24

The Delhi government is likely to discuss the recent rise in H1N1 infections at the Cabinet meeting on Tuesday, amid increasing influenza-A cases reported across the capital and directions to strengthen surveillance and preparedness at hospitals.

Health Minister Pankaj Singh has directed chief district medical officers, district surveillance officers and hospitals to step up the screening, reporting and monitoring of influenza-like illness (ILI) and severe acute respiratory infections (SARI).

The directions came after Singh participated in a health review meeting



chaired by Union Health and Family Welfare Minister J P Nadda, who called for sustained surveillance, vigilance and early clinical intervention to prevent further transmission. Delhi health authorities have reported 2,392 influenza-A cases this year, including 1,777 H1N1 infections.

An official said technical protocols covering patient categorisation, treatment, ventilatory support, mask

use and home-based care have already been shared with healthcare facilities. "Healthcare workers are being sensitised and trained on symptoms and follow-up protocols," the official said.

Singh said there had been a "definite rise" in cases, with several patients reporting high-grade fever, but said authorities had not received reports of patients requiring ICU

CAPITAL RECORDED 31 H1N1 DEATHS IN '19, BUT HAS REPORTED NO DEATHS FROM THE INFECTION SINCE THEN, INCLUDING DURING THE '24 OUTBREAK

admission or ventilator support.

He earlier said the government was prepared to handle the situation and maintained that there was no shortage of beds, doctors, medicines or essential medical equipment.

The minister has also urged residents to take basic precautions, including maintaining hand hygiene, wearing masks in crowded places, avoiding

close contact with people suffering from respiratory infections and consulting doctors instead of self-medicating.

However, the current numbers remain below some of Delhi's previous major H1N1 outbreaks. According to NCDC data, the city reported 4,307 cases in 2015, 3,627 in 2019 and 3,151 in 2024.

Delhi recorded 31 H1N1 deaths in 2019, but has reported no deaths from the infection since then, including during the 2024 outbreak.

Doctors said the increase this year could be linked to multiple factors, while stressing the importance of monitoring the trend and identifying severe cases early.



Commuters waded through the waterlogged Zakhira railway underpass, in Delhi PTI

AAP accuses BJP of failing city amid widespread waterlogging

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

Delhi AAP chief Saurabh Bharadwaj on Monday questioned the Delhi government and said the entire city has been suffering from severe waterlogging, and shared videos showing roads and commercial areas inundated with rainwater.

Sharing a video from Sadar Bazaar, Bharadwaj said the city's prominent commercial hub was flooded with waist-deep water, alleging that shops had been inundated and goods damaged.

"This scene is from Sadar Bazar, Delhi's most famous commercial hub. Water has flooded the shops, goods are being ruined, and shopkeepers are left helpless," he said

in a post on X. However, there was no immediate response available from BJP or Delhi government.

Bharadwaj questioned the administration's claims of extensive drain cleaning.

"Ever since the four-engine government was formed, the entirety of Delhi has been suffering from severe waterlogging. The grand claims of drain cleaning have been thoroughly exposed. When will the administration wake up from its slumber?" Bharadwaj said. In another post, he shared a video showing schoolchildren playing in water accumulated on a road and took a swipe at the BJP government.

AAP leaders Atishi and Saurabh Bharadwaj mocked the Delhi government over waterlogging, calling inundated

areas "free water parks" and "swimming pools". Heavy rain triggered widespread waterlogging and traffic snarls.

DIFFERENT PLOT NORMS SET FOR SCHOOLS Schools may have to reserve 15% FAR for extracurriculars

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 24

Schools in Delhi will have to use at least 15 percent of their permissible Floor Area Ratio (FAR) for infrastructure supporting extra-curricular activities under the proposed Master Plan for Delhi-2047 (MPD-2047), putting sports, cultural and other student-focused facilities at the centre of school planning.

The provision is part of the Development Control Norms (DCN) for educational facilities under the Public and Semi-Public (PSP) use category. The plan specifically states that, in the case of schools, "minimum 15%

SCHOOLS MAY BUILD SQUASH COURTS, TABLE TENNIS ROOMS OUTSIDE FAR CALCULATIONS...

of the permissible FAR shall be utilised for developing infrastructure for extra-curricular activities" in accordance with the National Education Policy or any other policy adopted by the Delhi government. The provision applies to schools as part of a wider set of planning norms aimed at ensuring that educational premises provide facilities beyond classrooms and academic spaces.

Under MPD-2047, a school is defined as a premise having educational and playing facilities

for students. The plan prescribes different development controls depending on the level of schooling. A school up to Class VI must have a minimum plot size of 2,000 sqm, with 40 per cent ground coverage and FAR of 150. For schools up to Class XII, the minimum plot size is 4,000 sqm, ground coverage is capped at 40 per cent and the maximum FAR is 180.

The plan also seeks to address the shortage of dedicated sports infrastructure in schools. It allows built-up space of up to 150 sqm, free from

ground coverage and FAR calculations, for facilities such as squash courts, table tennis rooms and associated facilities including changing and pump rooms. Another provision states that where there are space constraints, schools may develop playgrounds on a shared basis.

For new schools, the front boundary wall will have to be recessed by six metres to accommodate visitor parking. The MPD-2047 framework also allows up to 200 sqm, including FAR, for support facilities such as retail shops, post offices, bank counters with ATMs and health facilities, alongside extracurricular infrastructure.

508 kg spurious paneer destroyed Food safety inspections

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

The Delhi Food Safety Department destroyed around 508 kg of spurious paneer during an enforcement drive at Okhla Sabzi Mandi and collected 22 food samples from across the city for laboratory testing.

Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said strict action would be taken against food adulteration, particularly ahead of festivals.

Dedicated teams have been deployed across districts to inspect food establishments, markets and supply points, with intensified checks planned during Raksha Bandhan and other upcoming festivals.

AAP brings boat & oar to MCD House

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 24

A boat and an oar were brought into the Municipal Corporation of Delhi House on Monday as AAP councillors staged a symbolic protest over waterlogging, blocked roads and alleged civic failures during the monsoon.

The Opposition said the props highlighted conditions in several parts of Delhi where waterlogging has disrupted traffic and daily life. "We have to show the BJP Mayor what they have done to the capital," councillors said, alleging repeated congestion and poor road conditions.

The demonstration took place during a House meeting where councillors discussed stray animals and measures to prevent mosquito-borne diseases, including dengue, malaria and chikungunya. Mayor Pravesh Wahi said a special House meeting would be held soon to discuss stray animals and mosquito-borne diseases. He also accused some AAP councillors of disrupting proceedings and warned of action for "unparliamentary conduct".

Neema Bhagat, Jyoti Aggarwal, Shivani Panchal and Chitra Vidyarthi were elected to the DDA Advisory Council.

BRICS SUMMIT NDMC tightens civic monitoring

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has drawn up an extensive civic preparedness plan for the upcoming BRICS Summit, with round-the-clock sanitation, beautification and monitoring measures planned across the council area.

NDMC Chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi said 41 major roads had been divided into 14 circles, each headed by a nodal officer who would conduct daily inspections with field teams. The council has also identified 15 locations for floral boards, nine for floral fountains and 17 roundabouts for special illumination and landscaping.

Focus on cleanliness
Additional sanitation workers and night-duty teams will be deployed

from September 9 to 14. Mechanical road sweepers, scrubbers and other equipment will be used for intensive cleaning, while temporary dustbins and mobile toilets will be installed at identified locations.

The council will also undertake pothole and footpath repairs, maintain storm-water drainage, inspect public toilets and ensure functioning streetlights. Special measures will be taken to prevent waterlogging during rainfall.

Enforcement and monitoring
NDMC will intensify action against encroachments, illegal parking and hoardings, inspect food establishments and strengthen mosquito control. A 24x7 command centre will monitor civic services during BRICS events.



Government of India

10 Years of UPI

Digital, Self-Reliant, Worry-Free

Today, crores of people across the country use UPI in their daily lives

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In 2025-26, India made payments worth ₹314 lakh crore through UPI, nearly ₹1 crore worth of transactions every second

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Besides India, UPI is operational in 11 other countries, including France, Singapore, the UAE, Greece and Mauritius

"Today, from the street vendor to the showroom of your car, all your payments are done just by scanning a QR code." - Narendra Modi, Prime Minister

From page 1

Rain brings Delhi-NCR

Similar conditions were reported in Sadar Bazar, while commuters struggled through the Zakhira underpass. Traffic was bumper-to-bumper around Sarai Kale Khan, Dwarka Expressway, Bishambar Das Marg, Parliament Street, ITO and Connaught Place. Ghazipur and Sainik Farms were also affected by waterlogging.

The rain exposed problems on roads as well. Residents of Greater Kailash said potholes became difficult to identify after filling with water. "Once the potholes fill with rainwater, you cannot judge their depth. It becomes particularly dangerous for two-wheelers," a resident said. Another commuter said waterlogging during heavy rain was expected, but potholes in residential areas should not become hidden hazards.

Rainfall varied sharply across Delhi. Ayanagar recorded 69.1 mm between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, while Palam received 58.2 mm, Ridge 43.2 mm, Lodi Road 41.7 mm and Safdarjung 34.6 mm. Other readings included Janakpuri at about 67-70 mm during the intense spell, Chhatarpur at 57 mm and Pitampura at 35 mm. Earlier readings showed Chhatarpur receiving 28 mm, Lodi Road 24.6 mm and Pitampura 18.5 mm between 8.30 am and 11.30 am.

The rainfall has pushed Delhi's seasonal totals above normal at several observatories. By August 24, Safdarjung had received 246.2 mm against a normal 191.1 mm, an excess of 29 per cent. Palam's 227.2 mm was 28 per cent above normal, while Lodi Road's 233.2 mm was 22 per cent above normal. Ridge recorded 243 mm, 50 per cent above normal, and Ayanagar received 266.3 mm, 66 per cent above normal.

At Indira Gandhi International Airport, bad weather disrupted flight operations. At least 15 Delhi-bound flights were diverted, including 12 to Jaipur, two to Chandigarh and one to Lucknow. Three of the diverted flights were international. Flight-tracking data showed 26 cancellations and more than 400 delays. IndiGo, Air India and SpiceJet advised passengers to check their flight status before travelling to the airport. IGIA handles more than 1,300 flight movements a day.

Gurugram faced severe disruption after roughly an hour of heavy rain. Narsinghpur, Hero Honda Chowk, Rajiv Chowk, IFFCO Chowk, Railway Road, Sector 5, Old Delhi Road, Mehrauli Road and Basai Road were among the worst-hit locations. Naharpur underpass, Sheeta Mata Road and a stretch of the expressway near Cyber Hub opposite Gateway Tower Metro station were also submerged.

School buses and ambulances were stranded on Sohna Road, while buses remained stuck for hours near Rail Vihar in Sector 47 and Subash Chowk. A resident said on X that their child had been trapped in a bus for more than four hours. Traffic police deployed personnel to manage congestion near the Sirhaul border, Rajiv Chowk and Narsinghpur, and used drones to monitor flooded roads and identify sensitive locations.

The Gurugram administration responded by advising corporate and private offices to allow employees to work from home on August 25. Government and private schools and other educational institutions were also directed to conduct classes online, citing student and staff safety and the likelihood of further waterlogging and congestion. Deputy Commissioner Uttam Singh said the work-from-home measure would also allow civic agencies to carry out road and drain repairs.

Municipal Commissioner Pradeep Dahiya and Additional

Municipal Commissioner Yash Jaluka inspected affected areas with officials from the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority and the National Highways Authority of India. Dahiya directed teams to keep pumping arrangements active and reach waterlogged locations quickly.

The disruption extended beyond Delhi-NCR. Faridabad recorded 58 mm of rain, while heavy showers affected parts of Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Himachal Pradesh. Ghaziabad saw severe waterlogging and traffic congestion, with an auto-rickshaw overturning after hitting a pothole. In Rajasthan, Jaipur and several districts including Alwar, Dholpur, Karauli, Bharatpur and Dausa received heavy rain. Moti Dungri Road in Jaipur was submerged, while Kherthal-Tijara and Kishangarhbas saw flooding.

In Himachal Pradesh, 98 roads were closed, including 49 in Mandi and 28 in Kullu. Twenty-one power transformers and 21 drinking water schemes were also disrupted. Odisha saw particularly heavy rainfall, with Joda recording 169.4 mm, Papadahandi 158.8 mm and Paikmal 120 mm. Eight locations received more than 100 mm.

The IMD attributed Delhi's intense spell to the interaction of a middle- and upper-level western disturbance with a lower-level trough extending from a low-pressure area over Gangetic West Bengal towards southwest Uttar Pradesh. The agency forecast another spell of light to moderate rain overnight, with isolated heavy rain of 20-30 mm possible. Meteorologist Navdeep Dahiya said nearly 70 per cent of Delhi could receive moderate rain on Tuesday, although "the weather activity might not be as strong as it was today."

Delhi's maximum temperature remained below normal, with Safdarjung at 32.3°C, while the minimum was 27.8°C, 1.4 degrees above normal. The IMD expects conditions to become largely dry from Tuesday, though very light rain may occur in the afternoon, followed by light showers at a few places on Wednesday and isolated moderate rain later in the day.

India heads

its initial outlook. India has already received 13% less rain than normal since June 1. Rainfall was 35.4 per cent below average in June, followed by a 1 per cent surplus in July, before the deficit widened again in August to 15 per cent.

A senior IMD official said the strengthening El Nino weather pattern was affecting the monsoon and could bring a double-digit rainfall deficit in September. The official said rainfall could reach only 85% of normal during the season. The IMD is expected to release its official September forecast at the end of August.

Most parts of India, except some eastern states, are expected to receive below-average rainfall next month. Poor rains during September, an important period for crop development, could affect yields of cotton, soybean, corn and pulses. Lower rainfall could also reduce soil moisture needed for winter crops such as wheat and rapeseed.

The monsoon supplies about 70 per cent of India's annual rainfall, making its performance important for farm output, rural incomes and food prices.

El Nino, marked by unusually warm sea surface temperatures in the central and eastern equatorial Pacific, is strengthening and is expected to intensify further in September. The climate pattern can reduce rainfall over India and has been associated with below-average monsoon rains in many previous years.

draws from the country by mid-October.

Jaishankar

"We are doing everything we can to fully meet the needs of Indian farmers and the agricultural sector," he said, according to state-run TASS.

Putin also said bilateral trade had grown this year after recording a slight decline last year. He said cooperation between the two countries now covered virtually all areas, involving governments, parliaments and businesses.

During the meeting, Jaishankar conveyed Prime Minister Narendra Modi's greetings and a personal communication to Putin. He said Modi looked forward to meeting the Russian president at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in Kyrgyzstan from August 31 to September 1, followed by Putin's visit to India for the BRICS Summit on September 12-13.

Earlier, Jaishankar held talks with Russian First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov on expanding trade and economic ties. At the India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission meeting, Jaishankar said bilateral goods trade had risen four-fold in five years, from about USD 13 billion in 2021-22 to nearly USD 60 billion in 2025-26.

However, he said the trade imbalance had also widened sharply, with the deficit rising from USD 6.6 billion to more than USD 50 billion. "Addressing this imbalance is today one of our foremost priorities," he said.

Jaishankar said better market access, removal of tariff and non-tariff barriers, stronger payment mechanisms and greater business engagement would be needed to reach the shared target of USD 100 billion in bilateral trade by 2030.

He is also scheduled to meet Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov to discuss regional and global issues. The two last met in Manila on July 22, where they reviewed bilateral ties and discussed the Ukraine conflict and the situation in West Asia.

Amravati

Chief Minister Vendra Fadnavis expressed grief over the incident and directed the health administration to conduct a high-level investigation into the cause of the fire and any administrative lapses. He said strict action would be taken against those found responsible. Fadnavis also directed Health Minister Prakash Abitkar and the health secretary to visit Amravati and review the situation. The government will bear the treatment costs of injured children, while the families of each deceased infant will receive Rs 5 lakh in ex-gratia assistance.

Abitkar later announced a seven-member committee headed by the state health commissioner to investigate the incident. The panel will include officials from the Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Company Ltd (MSEDCL), experts from the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) and representatives of the Directorate of Medical Education. It has been asked to submit its report within eight days and determine both the exact cause of the fire and responsibility for the lapses.

"I reviewed the situation at the hospital today along with the secretary of the department and some local representatives. The situation here is horrific and unfortunate. Whatever irregularities were there at the hospital were grave ones," Abitkar told reporters.

He also questioned how a hospital built only two years ago could witness such an incident. "The hospital was constructed just two years back and then such a fire incident took place. It is absolutely wrong," he said.

Parents and relatives gathered outside the hospital alleged serious failures in fire safety arrangements. They claimed that the fire alarms did not sound and the auto-

matic sprinklers failed to operate as smoke spread through the ward.

Eyewitnesses said security guards and nurses entered the smoke-filled unit before fire tenders arrived and pulled infants from cradles and incubators. Two nurses on duty said they worked to evacuate all nine babies from the out-born section despite intense heat and poor visibility.

Yogesh Savarkar, whose eight-day-old child was admitted on the first floor, said he rushed inside after the alarm was raised. "My child was on the first floor, and I personally went and brought him down. However, I could see black ashes on the other children in the hospital," he said.

The incident also drew criticism from Opposition parties. Senior NCP (SP) leader Anil Deshmukh alleged that recommendations made after the 2021 Bhandara hospital fire, in which 10 infants died, had not been implemented. Congress leader Yashomati Thakur questioned the reported ventilator explosion and called for an examination of electrical connections and the role of equipment suppliers.

Amid the criticism, Abitkar defended the hospital staff, saying they made every possible effort to rescue the infants. The government inquiry will now examine the fire, the hospital's safety systems and the administrative responsibility for the deaths.

CJP to hit

young citizens from across the country expected to join.

The decision followed a meeting of the CJP's National Working Committee on Monday, where the organisation reviewed the commitments made to protesters on July 25, after which its nationwide agitation was called off.

The CJP alleged that instead of acting on those assurances, the government had delayed decisions and avoided giving clear commitments. It particularly raised the issue of FIRs registered against students and protesters.

The organisation said, "Our patience cannot be mistaken for weakness. Our good faith cannot become an opportunity for the government to betray us."

It further said it had been "forced to return to the streets", alleging that the government appeared determined to commit "vishwasghaat" with Gen-Z and families who had already lost their children.

Referring to the Supreme Court proceedings on August 18, the CJP alleged that the Centre had not given a clear commitment regarding FIRs registered against protesters. The organisation said the court had sought a list of such FIRs so that the cases could potentially be considered together.

The group said the July 25 assurances had been accepted in good faith and warned that the trust of young protesters could not be used to end a movement only for the commitments to subsequently be diluted.

"A government cannot take the trust of an entire generation, use it to send them home, and then quietly retreat from its own word," the CJP said.

The organisation has urged students, youth organisations and young citizens to gather at India Gate and participate peacefully. It said the families who lost their children would walk at the front, followed by victims of alleged police brutality and young protesters.

Meanwhile, CJP founder and convenor Abhijeet Dipke has written to education ministers seeking state-wise information on government schools. His letter seeks data on school renovations, buildings requiring repairs, sanctioned and vacant teaching posts, funding and expenditure, the need for additional schools, and the availability of computers, digital learning facilities, functional toilets and sports infrastructure.

"No child in this country should be forced to study in such conditions," Dipke said,

calling for public education to be treated as an urgent priority.

The CJP has also questioned the reported Rs 92.35 crore spent on renovation, furnishing and repairs of Union ministers' official residences in 2025-26. The organisation said, "Stop fixing your lavish homes, and fix the schools!" and claimed the amount could fund "10 new world-class government schools".

The CPWD reportedly spent Rs 547.68 crore on such works over 12 years. Officials have attributed the rising expenditure to maintenance requirements of ageing bungalows.

With the September 5 mobilisation and its parallel 'School Theek Karo' campaign, the CJP is broadening its youth movement from examination-related grievances to education, accountability and implementation of government commitments.

Doval in Beijing

Wang would discuss the boundary question in depth, along with bilateral, regional and international issues. He described the Special Representatives mechanism as the main channel for boundary negotiations and an important platform for communication on issues of mutual interest.

The mechanism was established in 2003 to address the 3,488-km India-China border dispute. Although it has not resolved the boundary question, both sides regard it as a useful framework for handling tensions. Lin said the 24th round of talks in August last year produced several common understandings and that the latest meeting would build on them to maintain peace and tranquillity along the border.

The talks come as relations continue to recover from the 2020 Galwan Valley clash and the prolonged military stand-off in eastern Ladakh. Doval is also scheduled to call on Chinese Vice President Han Zheng.

Border tensions remain a concern, particularly over Arunachal Pradesh. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar recently said peace and tranquillity along the border are necessary for stable India-China relations. India has also rejected China's objections to its decision to assign standard names to 27 places and geographical features in Arunachal Pradesh, reiterating that the state is an integral part of India.

China, which claims Arunachal Pradesh as part of South Tibet, has issued its own names for locations in the region since 2017.

Govt plans

Once the airports are awarded, there will be a one-year joint management period involving the current workforce. The private operator will then be required to retain 60 per cent of AAI employees for up to three years.

"The previous round of transaction provided for 1-year joint management period and 2-year deemed deputation period," the document said, adding that such arrangements had been acceptable to AAI employees.

The airports were selected through a phased assessment by AAI. Initially, 12 major airports were examined on passenger traffic, land availability, commercial potential, financial performance and airport-specific factors, with six shortlisted for leasing.

AAI subsequently assessed 136 smaller airports for possible combinations, considering traffic potential, capital expenditure, geographical proximity, city-side development potential and financial viability. After evaluating different combinations, the AAI Board approved the proposal for five major and six smaller airports at its May 23, 2022 meeting.

The government had earlier awarded six AAI airports under the PPP model in 2018-19.

Air passenger

in the March quarter. Pension fund management services recorded inflation of 5.20 per cent in the June quarter, compared with deflation of 0.76 per cent in the previous quarter. Insurance service prices rose 0.98 per cent, up from 0.68 per cent, while telecom prices increased 0.72 per cent, compared with 0.99 per cent in March.

The government also released final Service PPI estimates for the March quarter of 2025-26. The index tracks changes in the average prices received by producers for providing services.

The Centre plans to expand the coverage of Service PPI to include more services. It released its first PPI data for both goods and services in June as part of a broader move to improve measurement of price changes at the producer level.

The new framework is also expected to support a gradual shift away from wholesale price index (WPI)-based inflation numbers over the next five years. The move follows recommendations of a working group headed by former NITI Aayog member Ramesh Chand.

The panel, formed on December 30, 2024, was tasked with revising the WPI base year from 2011-12 to 2022-23 and developing the PPI with 2022-23 as its base year.

In its report submitted in April, Chand said PPI, covering Output PPI for goods and Services PPI, offers a more suitable measure of price changes from the producer's perspective and can support National Accounts and GDP compilation, including estimates of real value addition.

US plans to hike

amount as a separate, additional H-1B fee rather than combining it with the existing H-1B petition fee, the notice said.

"Same number. New wrapper. Same playbook. Throw enough things at the wall to restrict legal immigration and eventually something might stick (this won't)," said Emily Neumann, a US-based immigration attorney.

The US Congress set the current annual regular cap for the H-1B category at 65,000, commonly known as the "regular cap". It also set aside 20,000 additional H-1B visas for workers who hold a master's degree or higher from a US college, commonly called the Master's cap.

The impact of the fee could be felt by Indians working in the US on H-1B visas. Indian nationals have historically accounted for a large share of H-1B beneficiaries, making changes to the program particularly significant for Indian professionals and their employers.

According to US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS), 399,402 H-1B petitions, covering both initial and continuing employment, were approved in fiscal year 2024.

The agency's data shows that 71% of approved beneficiaries were born in India, far ahead of any other country.

Onion prices

The move comes as onion prices have risen sharply over the past year. The all-India average retail price stood at Rs 43.53 per kg on August 24, up 59 per cent from Rs 27.37 a year earlier. The average wholesale price increased 68 per cent to Rs 35.58 per kg from Rs 21.23.

Retail prices were Rs 60 per kg in Chennai and Rs 55 in Delhi, compared with Rs 33 and Rs 35, respectively, a year ago. Kolkata recorded a retail price of Rs 53 per kg.

The buffer onions will be released in both wholesale and retail markets. Agencies NCCF and Nafed will sell the stock in retail markets at Rs 35 per kg.

Khare said the government is closely tracking prices and market conditions. "Mandi prices in Nasik are ruling

higher than Delhi, which should be the case. It means cartelisation and speculation are at work," she said.

The Centre has 1.21 lakh tonnes of onion in its buffer stock for 2026, while onion production for 2025-26 is estimated at 307.37 lakh tonnes, broadly similar to 307.67 lakh tonnes in the previous year.

Onion prices generally rise during August-September due to festive demand, weather disruptions and supply-chain movements. The government uses buffer stocks for targeted market intervention during such periods.

The Kanda Express initiative, launched in 2024-25, has expanded from 14 railway rakes carrying nearly 12,000 tonnes to 86 rakes carrying about 88,000 tonnes in 2025-26. The latter consignments were sent to 16 major cities.

MPOST

No more boarding pass stamps

"Boarding passes will no longer be stamped during immigration clearance," the agency said, while clarifying that physical boarding passes will continue to be accepted.

A senior officer involved in airport security said the digital system will also remove the requirement for the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) to stamp boarding passes before passengers board their flights.

The change is part of the BoI's move towards a paper-free process for international air travellers, allowing passengers to complete the required checks using digital boarding passes on their mobile devices.

MPOST

'Who is mole among us?': Champat Rai

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Ayodhya, August 24

'Who is the mole among us?' This question, recorded in former Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust general secretary Champat Rai's communication with close confidante, raises concern inside the temple management over how Samajwadi Party leader Akhilesh Yadav came to know about the Ram temple donation theft while an internal inquiry was still underway.

Rai asks who passed the information to Yadav and how details of the sensitive case travelled outside the temple premises. The question emerged as the temple management was simultaneously tracing the missing money, questioning counting staff and recovering cash from their homes.

The sequence began on June 4 when Rai was travelling to Ayodhya by train number 14206 Delhi-Ayodhya Express. At around w9.30 pm, he received a WhatsApp message from worker Anand Chaudhary informing him that a bundle of currency notes had been found in the toilet of the hundi counting room.

The amount was around Rs 2.25 lakh. When Rai reached Ayodhya the next day, the temple management began examining CCTV footage to find out how the money had reached the toilet and who had handled it. Suspicion fell on three employees who had worked in the second shift in the counting room.

On the night of June 5, the three men were stopped while leaving for home and questioned. The inquiry soon moved to their houses, with the employees being asked to bring money from their homes. Separate amounts were subsequently recovered.

PM INTERACTS WITH IFS OFFICER TRAINEES

PM Modi: Combine civilisational strengths with tech, innovation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 24

Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacted with a group of officer trainees of the 2025 batch of the Indian Foreign Service at the Seva Teerth here on Monday and encouraged the young diplomats to combine India's civilisational strengths with technology, innovation and effective communication to further bolster the country's global engagement.

He also urged them to serve as "catalytic agents" for India's economic engagement with the world.

During the interaction, the prime minister called upon the young diplomats to build strong grassroots-level engagement in the countries where they may be posted and deepen India's connection with local communities.

He encouraged them to expand their networks beyond traditional diplomatic circles and deepen engagement with people, the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) said in a statement.

The group comprised 50 IFS officer trainees, hailing from different states and UTs across the country.

During the interaction, Modi also emphasised that Indian missions should foster meaningful relationships not only with governments and institutions but also with people at the community level.

The prime minister encouraged the officer



Prime Minister Narendra Modi poses for photographs during an interaction with IFS Trainee Officers 2025, at Seva Teerth, in New Delhi

HIGHLIGHTS

- PM also urged officers to serve as 'catalytic agents' for India's economic engagement with the world
- The group comprised 50 IFS officer trainees, hailing from different states and UTs across the country

trainees to combine India's civilisational strengths with technology, innovation and effective communication to further strengthen India's global engagement.

He also emphasised the importance of strengthening the digital presence of Indian missions.

Modi said a website is often the first gateway through which people interact with an institution, as he called for greater use of technology to make the delivery of consular and other services "more seamless, responsive and citizen-centric".

The prime minister

urged the officer trainees to work towards making India a "more attractive global tourism destination" by showcasing its civilisational, cultural and geographical strengths.

He suggested leveraging the 'Bharat ko Janiye' (Know India) Quiz to generate greater interest in India among young people across the world, and encouraged the use of AI and gaming to make such initiatives more engaging, the PMO said.

The officer trainees "shared their experiences from training and Bharat Darshan". They also spoke about the importance of

understanding India's civilisational and cultural links with the world, the statement said.

Modi also posted on X about his interaction with the officer trainees of the 2025 IFS batch and also shared some photos.

"Called upon our young diplomats to: Take diplomacy beyond traditional diplomatic circles and engage meaningfully with local communities and the diaspora. Become catalysts for India's economic engagement by identifying new opportunities for investment."

"Make our Missions more technology-driven and citizen-centric, strengthening their digital presence. Always ensure seamless and responsive consular services. Showcase India to the world by highlighting our civilisational heritage, culture and tourism potential," he posted.

Insult to 4 crore people of Telangana: CM Reddy on Centre's denial of US visit

'Move hurts cordial relations between the Centre and the state'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Hyderabad, August 24

Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy on Monday launched a sharp attack on Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the NDA government over the denial of his US visit, calling the decision "dictatorial" and an insult to the 4 crore people of the state.

Addressing a press conference, hours after returning from his UK visit, Reddy also responded to queries about reports of his proposed meeting with Zohran Mamdani, besides US Vice President JD Vance, and said the New York Mayor was not an "anti-social element."

Denial of permission to him was "a dictatorial deci-



Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy addresses a press conference, in Hyderabad, Monday

sion", and the move hurts cordial relations between the Centre and the state, the Chief Minister said.

Claiming that the Centre was discriminating towards Telangana, Reddy said the issue will be raised in Parliament by the Congress party.

"Refusal of permission to the Telangana Chief Minister to visit the US is not about Revanth Reddy as an individual. The refusal is an insult to 4 crore Telangana people. The rejection is Gujarat's domination. The Prime Minister is still behaving like a Gujarati and not as India's Prime Minister with knowledge. This is highly objectionable," Revanth Reddy said.

While the Centre permitted Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel to visit the US to attract investments into his state, it denied him permission, Reddy said.

Alleging that the denial was done "deliberately" and that there was a "conspiracy", he accused the

Centre and the BJP of not wanting any state to grow beyond a point.

"They (Centre) said clearance from a political angle is declined. What is political? The reason is that Narendra Modi and Bhupendra Patel belong to Gujarat. He has permitted the Gujarat CM to visit the US," he asserted.

"Narendra Modi thinks that he is an ambassador for Gujarat. He does not want any other parts of the country to grow. He said 'sab ka sath, sab ka vikas'. Where is the 'vikas' (development)? Why have you refused me permission to travel to the US? The reason is simple. They don't want any state to grow beyond a point," he alleged.

Vande Mataram row spills over to corruption as BJP, CM Sukhu tirade charges, Oppn walk-out

ASHWANI SHARMA

Shimla, August 24

What began as a row over 'Vande Mataram' on the opening day of the Himachal Pradesh Assembly's monsoon session has now spilled into a corruption slugfest, with the BJP staging an 'empty-suitcase' protest outside the House and Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu questioning the basis of the allegations.

Instead, the chief minister appeared more combative, accusing the BJP of a "suitcase" culture to buy nine Congress MLAs in its



bid to topple his government in 2024 during the Rajya Sabha poll.

"There is not even a single corruption charge against any minister. This government has zero tolerance against corruption. Today, the BJP was carrying empty suitcases in its protest. These suitcases

have become a symbol of horse-trading to buy Congress MLAs during the Rajya Sabha poll in 2024," he alleged, speaking to media persons here.

Earlier in the day, the BJP held a protest outside the state Assembly, accusing the government of corruption and reminding it that a former PCC vice president, Neeraj Bharti, had spoken about suitcases being collected and sent to Delhi.

Led by Jairam Thakur, leader of the Opposition, the BJP MLAs carried five empty suitcases to protest against what they alleged was the

Sukhu government's protection of corruption. The symbolism centred on the BJP's allegation that five suitcases of money were collected and shared with the central Congress leaders, as alleged by Bharti.

The row over Vande Mataram, which started on August 21, continued to dominate the House proceedings on the third consecutive day with Opposition BJP insisting that the video clip showing the national anthem being played on the opening day of the session must be provided to it.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी का 'स्वच्छ भारत मिशन' - दिल्ली का जन-अभियान

आइए, स्वच्छ दिल्ली के लिए सब साथ मिलकर कदम बढ़ाएं

स्वच्छता अभियान

दिल्ली को कूड़े से आज़ादी

17 अगस्त - 2 अक्टूबर, 2026

स्वच्छ दिल्ली के लिए

क्या करें?

कूड़ा हमेशा डस्टबिन में डालें

गीला और सूखा कूड़ा अलग रखें

घर, दुकान और अपने आसपास सफाई रखें

RWA, वार्ड, बाजार व स्कूलों के स्वच्छता अभियान से जुड़ें

क्या न करें?

सार्वजनिक स्थानों पर गंदगी न फैलाएं

नालियों में कचरा न डालें

प्लास्टिक व कचरा पार्कों में न छोड़ें

सड़क, पार्क या खाली प्लॉट में कूड़ा न फेंकें

कहीं कूड़ा दिखे तो MCD (311 ऐप) पर शिकायत दर्ज करें

शिकायत के लिए swachhdelhi2026@gmail.com पर ईमेल करें या 011 - 23392270 पर सूचना दें।

स्वच्छ दिल्ली हम सबकी जिम्मेदारी

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/075/26-27

HOSPITAL AUTHORITIES ‘SQUARELY BLAMED’

Silent alarms & failed sprinklers: Kin recount horror of Amravati NICU fire

MPOST BUREAU
Amravati, August 24

Grieving relatives of three newborns killed in a fire at the Neonatal Intensive Care Unit (NICU) of Maharashtra’s District Women’s Hospital have alleged that the tragedy could have been averted, claiming the fire alarms remained silent and the water-sprinkler system failed when flames engulfed the ward.

The blaze broke out around 3.15 am, turning the NICU into a smoke-filled death trap as parents, security guards and hospital staff scrambled to rescue critically ill infants. Thirty-six newborns were rescued, while three died.

Praful Chopde, whose five-day-old son died in the fire, accused the hospital administration of negligence and claimed the fire alarm did not sound when the blaze erupted. His wife and newborn had been admitted to the hospital on August 19.

Chopde’s relatives questioned why parents and security guards had to rush into the burning ward to save babies and alleged that hospital authorities failed to act immediately.

Swapnil Barge, a resident of Pulgaon, said his day-old son also died in the fire. He recalled standing near the hospital gate around 3.30 am when he heard a woman shouting, followed by chaos and the



Charred remains of medical equipment are seen after a fire in the NICU of a government hospital killed at least three newborns, in Amravati, Monday

HIGHLIGHTS

» The blaze, broke out around 3.15 am, turned the NICU into a smoke-filled death trap

» Parents, security guards and hospital staff scrambled to rescue critically ill infants

» Thirty-six newborns were rescued, while three died

» Praful Chopde, whose five-day-old son died in the fire, accused the hospital administration of negligence

» He claimed the fire alarm did not sound when the blaze erupted

» Relatives of other infants alleged that the ward’s sprinkler system failed to function

Relatives of other infants alleged that the ward’s sprinkler system, which should have activated as soon as the fire broke out, failed to function.

Yogesh Savarkar, a resident of Achalpur, said he was sleeping outside the hospital while his wife and eight-day-old child were admitted inside. On learning about the fire, he rushed to the first floor and carried his baby to safety.

“My child was on the first floor, and I personally went and brought him

down. However, I could see black ashes on the other children in the hospital,” Savarkar said.

He claimed security guards were among the first to reach the ward and help evacuate the babies, while a nurse also assisted in the rescue.

Another relative, whose grandson survived, said families sleeping in the waiting area received calls about the fire and rushed to the neonatal ward. The area was completely dark, he said, forcing relatives to use torches and mobile phone lights to locate the infants.

“It wasn’t like I was only looking for my child. We couldn’t tell which baby belonged to whom. We picked up whichever infant we saw,” he said.

He said a nurse had placed children on stretchers before they were shifted to other hospitals, including his grandson.

The families said they did not know the exact cause of the blaze but demanded accountability, compensation for those who lost their children and action against officials responsible for the alleged lapses.

The incident has also raised questions over fire-safety preparedness at the hospital, particularly the alleged failure of the alarm and sprinkler systems in a ward housing critically ill newborns.

MODI-TRUMP FRANCE MEET

Trump’s ‘unpredictable’ conduct behind no joint presser: Sources

New Delhi, August 24

US President Donald Trump’s “unpredictable behaviour” toward many foreign leaders prompted the Indian side to adopt a cautious approach and prefer against holding a media interaction following Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s talks with the American leader in France in June, government sources said on Monday.

The clarification came in response to public remarks by US envoy Sergio Gor, who said that New Delhi had informed the American side prior to the Modi-Trump meeting that it preferred not to hold a joint press briefing.

The sources emphasised that discussions regarding leaders’ public appearances are standard protocol and part of routine diplomatic practice.

Modi and Trump held bilateral talks on June 17 in Evian-les-Bains on the sidelines of the G7 summit. The meeting was widely



THE CLARIFICATION CAME IN RESPONSE TO US ENVOY GOR’S CLAIM THAT INDIA PREFERRED NOT TO HOLD A JOINT PRESSER

viewed as a step forward in mending bilateral ties, which had faced severe strain over the preceding year.

The fresh controversy comes amid a growing perception of a lack of intensity in overall relations between the two sides, with the much-talked-about bilateral trade deal remaining in limbo.

In the course of an

interactive session late last week, Gor, referring to friendship between Trump and Modi, brought up the the last in-person interaction between the two leaders at the French holiday resort town.

“We were behind the stage, and at one point it was just the president and I, and he asked me, ‘what are the Indians going to raise?’ We went over some topics, and he said, ‘do they have any asks?’”

The US envoy was speaking at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum. Gor said the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) had one “ask” and he told the president that the “Indians prefer no questions. He (Trump) said: ‘sure, no problem’”.

The US president suggested that the US president had forgotten the request and ended up taking many questions as the media interaction lasted for almost 45 minutes after the meeting with Modi.

AGENCIES

NSG begins Mahila Commando Course

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 24

The National Security Guard (NSG) Training Academy in Manesar has launched the first Mahila Commando Conversion Course (MCCC) for women personnel from state police forces and Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs), aimed at strengthening their operational

role in counter-terrorism.

The 12-week residential course will train participants in specialised counter-terrorism skills and prepare them for demanding operational assignments. The rigorous programme includes physical fitness, weapons training, tactical intervention, hostage rescue and other counter-terrorism modules.

The NSG said the initiative would expand the pool of trained women personnel available for counter-terrorism operations and strengthen coordination between state and central security agencies.

On completion of the course, the women personnel will return to their respective forces, carrying enhanced operational skills and expertise.

Briefs

Mohali emerging as AI hub: CM

CHANDIGARH: Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann on Monday said Mohali was fast emerging as a major hub for AI, digital innovation and Global Capability Centres (GCCs). After meeting a NASSCOM delegation, Mann said skilled talent, world-class infrastructure, Invest Punjab and the new GCC Policy 2026 were attracting technology companies.

‘Digital arrest’ case: 2 held in Goa

NEW DELHI: The ED has arrested Fahim Moin Hussain Sayed and Naim Mueen Sayyed in a Goa “digital arrest” cyber fraud case involving over Rs 2.60 crore. The ED said the accused routed victims’ funds through “Secret Supervision Accounts” into hundreds of beneficiary accounts. Searches in Mumbai and Goa recovered Rs 3.25 crore and electronic devices.

Assam: Drugs worth Rs 12 cr seized

GUWAHATI: Two persons were nabbed and drugs worth around Rs 12 crore seized in Assam’s Kokrajhar district on Monday, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said. The police seized 2,098 kgs of marijuana concealed in a vehicle carrying bamboo at Damrapara checking point.

Haryana mulls ‘dedicated’ policy for defence sector, says CM Saini

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 24

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday said the state is considering a dedicated policy for the defence sector as he sought greater investment from leading investors, global investment firms and industry representatives at a roundtable conference in Mumbai.

The meeting was held under the ongoing ‘Happening Haryana 2.0’ Global Capital Campaign, with Industries and Commerce Minister Rao Narbir Singh also present.

Saini said the maximum number of suggestions and expressions of interest received during the interaction were related to the defence sector, highlighting its potential for manufacturing and allied industries in Haryana.

He said the government was exploring cluster-based development for defence manufactur-

THE GOVT WOULD EXAMINE THE POSSIBILITY OF SETTING UP A DEFENCE CLUSTER NEAR HISAR, HE SAID

ing and would also examine the possibility of setting up a defence cluster near Hisar. A manufacturing cluster is being developed alongside Maharaja Agrasen Airport in Hisar. Another industrial cluster is planned in the Haryana region near Jewar Airport.

The Chief Minister said the state had announced 10 new Industrial Model Townships (IMTs) in the last Budget, with work related to land for these projects progressing.

Seeking to make Haryana a trusted and investor-friendly destination, Saini said the government would work on suggestions received from investors and convert them into time-bound action plans,

with clear departmental responsibility wherever required.

He said reforms would be undertaken to simplify processes relating to land, approvals and other procedures.

Saini invited companies exploring expansion, manufacturing, Global Capability Centres, technology and logistics opportunities to engage with the state government. He said Haryana wanted to build long-term partnerships with industry rather than merely attract investments.

The government is also working to link ITIs and polytechnic institutions with industries through MoUs so that young people can receive training aligned with industry requirements, he said.

Saini invited investors and their leadership teams to participate in the Happening Haryana Global Investor Summit scheduled to be held in the state in April 2027.

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 24

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Monday inaugurated 509 modern ‘Pendul Khed Maidan’ across the state, taking the total number of dedicated rural playgrounds to 734 and giving a major push to grassroots sports.

Mann said the initiative would provide rural youth with modern sporting facilities and strengthen the government’s campaign against drugs with the message, “Say No to Drugs, Say Yes to Sports.”

The Chief Minister said 3,100 Pendul Khed Maidan were being developed across Punjab with an allocation of Rs 1,500 crore. The grounds would offer facilities for football, cricket, volleyball and traditional sports, besides amenities for children and senior citizens.

The playgrounds will have high-mast lights,

INSIGHT

- » Mann said the initiative would provide rural youth with modern sporting facilities and strengthen the government’s campaign against drugs
- » He said 3,100 Pendul Khed Maidan were being developed in the state

walking tracks with footlights, chain-link fencing, football goalposts, volleyball poles and swings. Sports equipment will also be provided according to the games popular in individual villages. Mann said the state had dedicated 2026 to sports and sports persons and was also establishing rural gyms. Of the 6,000 rural gyms planned, 500 had already been inaugurated, he said.

He said the fourth season of ‘Khedan Wattan Punjab Diyan’ would begin

from Bathinda on September 5, with around 10 lakh players expected to participate.

Punjab will also host the Hockey Asian Champions Trophy for the first time, with matches scheduled in Jalandhar and Mohali during October-November. A T20 cricket league, on the lines of the IPL, will also be held at PCA Stadium, Mohali, from August 30 to September 13.

Highlighting the government’s sports spending, Mann said Punjab had allocated a record Rs 1,744 crore sports budget, including Rs 1,500 crore for rural playgrounds.

He said Rs 135 crore in prize money had been distributed to 40,415 sportspersons since 2022. Under the state’s sports policy, athletes are also receiving financial assistance for training and preparation, including Rs 15 lakh for the Olympics and Rs 8 lakh for Asian and Commonwealth Games.

Drive to clean Rly stations’ water tanks launched

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 24

Indian Railways has launched a special drive to clean and disinfect drinking-water tanks and filtration systems at stations across the country after the Comptroller and Auditor General of India flagged serious deficiencies, including harmful bacteria such as E. coli in water coolers at several stations.

“The initiative is part of a broader action plan for strengthening drinking-water quality management across Indian Railways. The action plan emphasises frequent inspection and maintenance of the entire drinking-water system, along with water-quality testing at the source as well as at the point of consumption, rather than relying solely on end-of-pipe water testing,” the Railway ministry said in a statement on Monday.

Earlier, the CAG audit of more than 512 stations revealed alarming issues regarding poor water quality. Following which, Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw conducted a review and ordered several corrective measures, including the installation of new water filtration systems, replacement of water tanks, and regular testing of water quality.

Vaishnaw also ordered the installation of a water-filtration-and-monitoring system at approximately 20,000 points across the railway network.

The ministry on Monday decided to undertake a comprehensive drive under which all 18 zones have been asked to undertake a detailed inspection of water sources, treatment and filtration plants, tanks, water booths and other points.

New threats, new tools: Shah pushes AI-led intelligence

Home minister Amit Shah inaugurates 9th National Security Strategies Conference-2026

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah on Monday inaugurated the ninth National Security Strategies (NSS) Conference-2026 in New Delhi, with more than 850 participants deliberating on a range of issues concerning the country’s security.

Before inaugurating the two-day conference, Shah laid a wreath at the Martyrs’ Column in memory of Intelligence Bureau personnel who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty while safeguarding the nation’s security and integrity.



Union Home minister Amit Shah with other officials during the NSS Conference-2026 in New Delhi

and integrity.

The conference is being held in hybrid mode, with Union Home Ministers of states and Union Territories, the Union Home Secretary, Deputy National Security Advisers, and

heads of Central Armed Police Forces and Central Police Organisations attending in person.

Directors General of Police from states and Union Territories, young police personnel working

KEY POINTS

» On the first day, delegates discussed key security challenges, including counter-terrorism & Pak proxy war

» Shah also called for stringent measures to check infiltration

at the cutting edge of innovation, and experts from various fields are participating virtually.

On the first day, delegates discussed key security challenges, including counter-terrorism, intelligence

sharing and analysis through the Multi Agency Centre (MAC), narcotics, detection and deportation of illegal immigrants, cybercrime and Pakistan’s proxy war. Shah called for focused efforts to ensure effective implementation of the Ministry of Home Affairs’ PRAHAAR scheme and directed agencies to expedite the trial of cases by bringing back absconders and making use of provisions allowing trials in absentia.

He also stressed the need for a coordinated and integrated approach to investigations in cases registered under the Unlawful

Activities (Prevention) Act.

The Home Minister directed agencies to use artificial intelligence to analyse data available with the MAC and prepare standard operating procedures to address different aspects of national security.

He also called for stringent measures to check infiltration and urged delegates to formulate a comprehensive response to emerging challenges.

The second day of the conference will focus on sub-aerial challenges and responses, security of the blue economy, information warfare and its impact on national security.

EDITORIAL

Protectionist Spiral

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rump has announced that tariffs on Canadian cars, trucks, automotive parts and steel will rise to 50 per cent from January 1, 2027, following the collapse of negotiations between Washington and Ottawa. Canada, meanwhile, is preparing retaliatory measures, raising the prospect of a prolonged cycle of tariffs and counter-tariffs. What makes the confrontation particularly consequential is that these are not distant trading partners exchanging finished products across oceans. Their industries have developed over decades as interconnected North American production systems in which components, raw materials and finished goods routinely cross the border. A tariff wall erected between them therefore risks functioning less as punishment of a foreign competitor than as a tax on their own shared industrial ecosystem.

The automobile industry demonstrates the danger most clearly. Vehicles assembled in North America can contain components manufactured on both sides of the border, sometimes crossing it several times before reaching consumers. Existing US measures already impose a 25 per cent tariff on Canadian automobiles, with relief for qualifying American content, while Canada-US-Mexico Agreement-compliant auto parts have enjoyed important exemptions. Raising barriers further threatens to increase manufacturing costs, disrupt investment decisions and ultimately make vehicles more expensive for American consumers. Steel presents similar complications because it feeds construction, machinery, automobiles and numerous downstream industries. Protection may benefit particular producers, but industries consuming protected materials can find themselves paying considerably more. The assumption that tariffs automatically translate into domestic industrial revival overlooks these complicated supply chains and the time, capital and labour required to recreate them within national borders.

The political deterioration is equally troubling. Canada has promised a “dollar-for-dollar” response to the latest US measures, with retaliatory tariffs expected on American products, while both governments blame the other for the breakdown of negotiations. Such retaliation is politically understandable but economically corrosive. Trade wars rarely remain confined to the sectors where they begin. Farmers, manufacturers, exporters, workers and consumers can become collateral participants in disputes over which they exercise little control. Businesses confronted with unpredictable tariff regimes may postpone investment or redesign supply chains, creating costs that remain even if governments eventually reconcile. More significantly, the confrontation raises questions about the future credibility of the USMCA framework itself. A trade agreement provides limited reassurance if political disagreements can repeatedly overwhelm the predictability businesses expect it to provide.

There is still time before the proposed 50 per cent automotive tariffs take effect in January, and that window should be used for negotiation rather than another round of escalation. Washington has legitimate grounds to pursue stronger domestic manufacturing, just as Ottawa is entitled to protect Canadian economic interests. But industrial resilience cannot sustainably be constructed through permanent economic confrontation with a neighbour whose factories, workers, energy networks and markets are intimately connected to one’s own. The US and Canada have spent generations turning geography into an economic advantage. Allowing tariffs to transform that advantage into a liability would leave both countries paying the price. The wiser course is not economic separation, but a negotiated reset that addresses genuine trade grievances without dismantling one of the world’s most important cross-border production relationships.

LETTER



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Skilled Squeeze

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he US move to make a fee exceeding \$100,000 permanent for new H-1B visas could disproportionately hurt Indian professionals, who dominate the programme. Such prohibitive costs risk restricting skilled mobility while burdening American employers dependent on global talent. Immigration reform should strengthen oversight without turning opportunity into a privilege reserved for wealthy corporations.

JOHN D’SOUZA,
ARUNACHAL PRADESH

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Can Vijay Break the Corruption Cycle?

Vijay’s call for eight crore citizens to fight corruption seeks to transform clean governance from a government promise into public participation

PEOPLE FIRST



G PALANITHURAI

THE WRITER IS A FORMER PROFESSOR AND RAJIV GANDHI CHAIR FOR PANCHAYATI RAJ STUDIES, GANDHIGRAM RURAL INSTITUTE



Tamil Nadu’s anti-corruption battle now needs active public participation

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fter the election to the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, I made a fervent plea that voters have to watch the new government and its activities, and whenever it takes decisions to transform governance and administration to achieve development, people have to join hands with the government to ensure that the benefits reach the needy. Unless people join the government in tracking the benefits, brokers will capture the programmes, and that is the practice we have seen so far in governance. The gap between the government and the people has to be narrowed. It can be done only by involving people with the government while implementing schemes and programmes. But now, in his Independence Day speech, after hoisting the national flag, the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu has made an appeal to the people of

Tamil Nadu to join the government in ending corruption. He is making an earnest effort to end corruption. It is almost a liberation struggle. In this struggle, eight crore people have to join hands with the government with a sense of commitment, as he has sensed that officials are in a mood to listen.

In the last fifty years, corruption has become a culture and a phenomenon in Tamil Nadu. Equally, the bureaucracy, from top to bottom, is involved in collection, and in this way, corruption has penetrated society very deeply. As a result, it has now become a value. If someone gives a bribe for a favour and it is done, it is considered honest. Who is dishonest, and what is dishonesty? If someone gets money by making a promise to a client but does not fulfil the promise as committed and

THE FIGHT AGAINST CORRUPTION CANNOT REMAIN THE GOVERNMENT’S BATTLE ALONE

does not return the money, he or she is considered dishonest. People never bother about the corrupt practices prevalent in public administration, even in the delivery of basic services to the poor. In one of the studies conducted by a leading research institution on household development, it was concluded that the per capita bribe is higher than the per capita tax. No political party took it up as an issue

with the people. The present Chief Minister, Vijay, has not disputed the development paradigm of the Dravidian parties, and that is why he continues the programmes launched by both Dravidian parties. He took corruption as an issue in the electoral battle. It is an issue from the perspective of the youth, which has been rightly perceived by Vijay and taken up as an issue. When he took it up as an issue, he stood by it and succeeded in the electoral battle. The real work started only when he assumed charge of governance and administration.

In Tamil Nadu, governance leaders have argued that the elected government works not only for the people who voted for it but also for those who did not vote for it. Now, the Chief Minister has said that it is a government for all eight crore people. Vijay

has categorically said that he can end corruption only when people join him in tackling this menace. He made a clear call for people to develop a new consciousness to oppose corrupt practices. People should not tolerate corruption. To liberate ourselves from corruption-ridden governance and administration, we have to wage a struggle jointly with the government and the people.

There is yet another vital message that he conveyed to the people during the speech. In order to achieve development and social justice for the people and to take the state to the next level, we have to coordinate with the Union Government, and there is no other alternative. On issues concerning the state, appropriate steps will be taken to protect its interests. This was the position of M.G.R. when he was the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu. Vijay has taken the stand of M.G.R., which is perceived positively by many in the new context. After hearing this speech, I contacted a few villagers over the phone and elicited their reactions and responses. Many said that he is pursuing his own course of action and that people have to participate in the struggle against corruption like freedom fighters.

One youth said, “I will create awareness among the rustic folk that whenever they face a problem in government offices, they have to immediately raise their voices in front of the office and bring it to the notice of the public. They have to inform the appropriate authority.” In this way, the youth decided to work with the government. His struggle will succeed as a large number of young people are with him. It is in the character of youth to struggle against injustice, unfairness and corruption. Now, the ball is in the court of the youth.

Views expressed are personal

Need for a Civic Renaissance

India’s economic progress must be matched by civic responsibility and public courtesy

PUBLIC CONDUCT



JOHN FELIX RAJ & PRABHAT KUMAR DATTA

JF RAJ IS THE VC, PK DATTA IS AN ADJUNCT PROFESSOR AT ST XAVIER’S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

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e wear our modern achievements like a badge of honour. India is rapidly advancing as a global tech powerhouse, our space programme is achieving unprecedented milestones, high-rise buildings are redefining our skylines, and world-class road networks span the nation. Yet, as we project a picture of a *Viksit Bharat* (Developed India)—backed by financial growth and academic excellence—a fundamental question remains: Has our public conduct kept pace with our infrastructural progress? Economic growth alone does not define a developed civilisation. The true marker of an advanced society lies in its daily civic habits—the quiet respect, empathy, and consideration citizens show one another in shared public spaces.

Our Public Behaviour

Walk down any bustling Indian street, and the contrast between private warmth and public indifference becomes stark. Within

our homes, hospitality and respect are paramount. Beyond the threshold, however, public interaction often dissolves into a chaotic struggle.

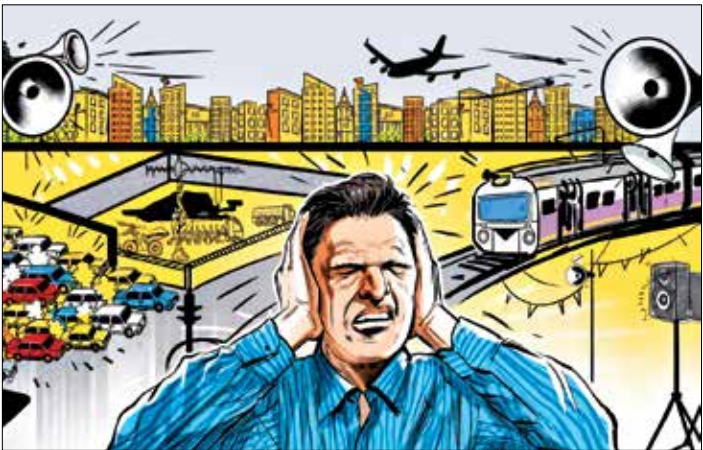
The “Me First” Loop: Routine public interactions—from cutting in line and crowding elevator doors to merging haphazardly into heavy traffic—are increasingly driven by an impatience to get ahead by just a few seconds. This behaviour is fuelled by a defensive psychological loop: when individuals assume others will break the rules, they abandon the rules themselves to avoid feeling left behind. Ultimately, this hyper-individualism creates systemic gridlock, turning minor infractions into daily aggression where everyone loses time.

A Culture of Noise: Pervasive honking—used not to warn, but as an outlet for frustration—creates a high-stress environment. Combined with loud phone conversations on speaker in public transport and late-night loudspeakers, noise has been normalised at the expense of communal well-being.

Disregard for Life and Memory: Perhaps the most painful indicator of our civic gap is the treatment of emergency and solemn vehicles. Sirens are frequently ignored in dense traffic, delaying ambulances carrying critical patients. Similarly, funeral processions—once met with a quiet pause and reverence—are often rudely overtaken by impatient drivers.

Anatomy of Civic Friction

The phrase “*The Anatomy of Civic Friction*” captures the structural breakdown that occurs when individual impulses clash in shared spaces. It isn’t just about bad manners—it describes a mechanical, recurring breakdown in how a society operates when public trust is absent.



Everyday public interactions increasingly reflect impatience

BETTER ROADS AND TECHNOLOGY MEAN LITTLE WITHOUT BETTER BEHAVIOUR

In physics, friction creates resistance, slows down movement, and generates heat. In a society, civic friction operates in exactly the same way:

Acoustic Hostility: Persistent noise—from incessant horn honking to blasting audio on public transit—functions as a continuous, ambient stressor. It raises collective anxiety and lowers the threshold for road rage and public outbursts.

Erosion of Shared Ownership: Viewing public property—streets, parks, transit systems—as “nobody’s space” rather than “everyone’s space” leads to littering, encroachment, and disrespect for civic boundaries.

Smooth civic life doesn’t require enforcement at every corner; it relies on an implicit agreement to give up a tiny fraction of

immediate convenience for the smooth operation of the collective whole.

A Lesson in the Queue

This clash between entitlement and civic order is best illustrated at a busy airport:

The departure hall was packed, and the check-in line stretched far down the terminal, filled with weary travellers waiting their turn. Out of nowhere, a well-dressed man barged past the long line of patient passengers, strode straight to the front, and slammed his ticket onto the counter.

“Process this immediately. I’m in a hurry,” he demanded.

The check-in agent offered a calm, professional smile. “Sir, I’d be happy to help you, but you’ll need to step to the back of the queue like everyone else.”

His face flushed with instant anger. Leaning over the counter, he bellowed for the entire terminal to hear, “Do you have any idea who I am?!”

Without flinching, the agent reached for her public address microphone, flipped the switch, and spoke clearly into the terminal’s loudspeakers:

“Attention, ladies and gentlemen in Terminal 2. We have a gentleman here at Gate 4 who does

not know who he is. If anyone can assist him in finding his identity, please step forward.”

As the terminal erupted into collective laughter and applause, the man turned crimson, grabbed his ticket, and quietly walked to the back of the line.

Building a Developed Civic Mindset

A nation cannot truly claim developed status if basic empathy is missing from everyday interactions. True modernisation requires upgrading our social contract alongside our infrastructure.

Strict Acoustic Discipline: Horns should be reserved exclusively for immediate danger, not for expressing routine irritation. Implementing strict no-honking zones near hospitals, schools, and residential communities is an essential first step.

Prioritising Emergency and Solemn Transit: Yielding the right of way to ambulances and allowing solemn passage for hearses are non-negotiable standards of basic human decency.

Cultivating Neighbourhood Empathy: Respecting physical boundaries, managing noise levels, and caring for shared residential spaces ensure that individual freedom does not infringe on community peace.

Instilling Civic Pride in Educational Institutions: Academic excellence must be paired with civic education. Teaching young minds the value of queuing, public courtesy, and consideration ensures long-term cultural change.

Economic prosperity provides the capability to build a modern nation, but collective empathy provides its soul. True progress is measured not just by the height of our skyscrapers or the speed of our trains, but by the quiet respect we offer each other in our daily lives.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Sri Lanka sees decline in overall tourist arrivals

COLOMBO: Tourist arrivals in Sri Lanka declined by over 1 per cent in the first seven months of 2026 compared to the same period last year, with India once again emerging as the country with the most visitors to the island nation.

More than 338,000 Indians arrived in Sri Lanka, an increase of 21.2 per cent from last year, according to data released by the Tourism Development Authority on Monday. The 338,000 Indian arrivals from January to July this year were an improvement from 279,122 in the same period last year.

Libya executes 10 convicted on terrorism charges

CAIRO: Authorities in eastern Libya said they executed 10 people after their conviction by military courts on terrorism-related charges.

The executions, announced Sunday, triggered condemnations by rights groups in the North African country that is divided between rival administrations, each backed by a set of militias and foreign governments.

The office of the military prosecutor in eastern Libya said the 10 people were executed by firing squad after yearslong trials.

Gang coalition unleashes new attack in Haiti

PORT-AU-PRINCE: A powerful gang coalition attacked a once peaceful farming community nestled in the hills above Haiti's capital, killing multiple people, an official told The Associated Press on Monday.

Kenscoff Mayor Jean Massillon said armed men raided the community late Sunday, setting fire to homes and killing residents.

"It is still impossible to establish a definitive death toll due to access difficulties and communication problems," he said.



France's President Emmanuel Macron, (left), greets Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman in Paris on Monday

AP/PTI

Briefs

Norway King's health worsens

OSLO: The health of King Harald of Norway deteriorated over the weekend, the royal palace said.

The 89-year-old monarch, who has been on sick leave for several weeks, was admitted to the National Hospital a week ago. He is now receiving antibiotics for a bacterial blood infection and has responded to treatment, the palace said late Sunday, adding that his condition is stable. His son, Crown Prince Haakon, has been serving as regent during that time, the palace said.

Sunni cleric killed in Pak

LAHORE: A renowned Sunni cleric was shot dead in a sectarian attack inside a mosque in Punjab province of Pakistan, police said Monday.

The incident took place in Shadiwal town of Gujrat, about 200 kms from Lahore, in the early hours of Sunday.

Sunni cleric Muhammad Talha Raza was present at the mosque when four armed men entered and opened fire on him, police said.

The attack left him critically injured and he was taken to a hospital, where he succumbed to his wounds.

Hungarian air force jet crashes

BUDAPEST: A Hungarian military pilot ejected safely when his fighter jet crashed on Monday, Prime Minister Péter Magyar said.

The Swedish-made JAS 39 Gripen came down near the city of Szolnok in central Hungary "for reasons that are still unknown," Magyar wrote in a post on Facebook. An investigation into the incident is underway and Minister of Defense Romulusz Ruszin-Szendi was on his way to the scene, he added.

Ruszin-Szendi said the pilot was "alive and has not sustained any injuries."

"It appears the pilot did everything he could to ensure the crashed aircraft landed on military property," Ruszin-Szendi said in a video on Facebook, adding he was traveling to the crash site with the chief of staff of the Hungarian defense forces.

'SANCTIONS AIM TO BLOCK POTENTIAL SOURCES OF REVENUE'

Iran warns of harsh response to anticipated US sanctions

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Dubai, August 24

Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesperson warned that Tehran would respond harshly to expanded US sanctions, including measures against countries it sees as cooperating with Washington.

"Any escalation of this situation will undoubtedly bring about consequences," Esmail Baghaei said. "Our hands are not tied." The new head of Iran's top security body warned Sunday that Tehran will see any country's support for the sanctions as an "act of war".

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said Monday that new US sanctions aim to block all potential sources of revenue for Iran and told nations to cut economic ties to Tehran or face retaliation.

Bessent said it's "no longer acceptable to operate in the gray spaces" of the



Representational Image

conflict.

He did not name what countries could face potential secondary sanctions from the United States, but China, Turkey and the United Arab Emirates are

Iran's largest trade partners. "Let there be no ambiguity as to the position of the United States," Bessent told a news conference. "An economic engagement of any kind

with this murderous regime will expose those responsible to the full reach of American power."

The expanded sanctions come after weeks of impasse. The United

KEY POINTS

- » 'Tehran will see any country's support for the sanctions as an act of war'
- » The expanded sanctions come after weeks of impasse

States has not dislodged Iran's grip on the Strait of Hormuz, through which a fifth of the world's traded oil passed before the war started nearly six months ago.

Iran's demands for reopening the strait include lifting the US naval blockade, withdrawing US forces from the region and reparations for damages sustained in the war. It has held separate talks with Oman, on the other side of the strait, on jointly managing the waterway regardless of whether a new deal is brokered with the US.

US strikes another boat in eastern Pacific

At least two people killed in first attack in months

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Washington, August 24

US forces have struck another vessel in the eastern Pacific Ocean, killing two people accused of trafficking drugs, the Department of Defence said Monday, in the first attack announced in about two months.

The death toll in the nearly yearlong US campaign of bombing boats allegedly trafficking drugs now exceeds 210 after more than 60 strikes off Latin America's Caribbean coast and in the eastern Pacific Ocean.

Forces "executed a lethal kinetic strike on a low-profile vessel operating along established

“WE ARE COMMITTED TO IMPOSING TOTAL SYSTEMIC FRICTION ON NARCO-TERRORISTS”

narcotrafficking routes in the Eastern Pacific," US Southern Command said on social media. As with most of the military's statements on strikes in the eastern Pacific Ocean and Caribbean Sea, the Pentagon did not provide evidence that the vessel was ferrying drugs.

It is the first strike since powerful back-to-back June 24 earthquakes that killed thousands of people.

Indonesia intensifies firefighting

ASSOCIATED PRESS

London, August 24

Indonesia intensified its ground and aerial firefighting operations on Monday as huge blazes in central and western regions scorched wide areas of forests and peatland, creating a choking haze that blanketed cities and crossed borders.

Emergency services have been battling fires driven by an intensifying El Nino pattern and a prolonged dry season, generating dense smoke that crossed into Malaysia and Brunei, according to the National Disaster Management Agency (BNPB).

Fires remained active in several regions on Monday, according to the agency.

Russia should be in no doubt of UK resolve: PM on Ukraine visit

ASSOCIATED PRESS

London, August 24

Andy Burnham chose Kyiv for his first international visit as British Prime Minister to mark 35 years since Ukraine's independence from the Soviet Union on Monday, condemning Russia's "illegal war" as he handed critical missile blueprints to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy.

Ahead of his visit, Downing Street confirmed that Burnham signed off on the European multinational defence firm MBDA releasing classified information on UK components for the long-range missile named SCALP, green-lighting local assembly lines for the weapons in Ukraine.

The missile is the French-produced version of the UK's Storm Shadow, with both using shared



Britain's PM Andy Burnham gestures as he meets patients injured in the war at the Main Military Hospital, in Kyiv on Monday

AP/PTI

French and British technology. "Despite Russia's outrageous threats to my country, we will continue our support for Ukraine," said Burnham.

The long-range SCALP missile is capable of hitting targets around 150 miles into Russia, seen as a significant step in showing the

willingness of international partners to share weapons technology.

While in Kyiv, Burnham compared Ukraine's resistance to Russia to the UK's fight with Nazi Germany: "My nation kept the flame of European freedom alive in the 20th century, you hold that flame in the 21st."

Kazakhstan's pro-govt party wins parliamentary election

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Astana, August 24

Kazakhstan's pro-government Adilet Party won a landslide victory in a parliamentary election, officials announced Monday, a result expected to further strengthen President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev's grip on power in Central Asia's largest nation.

Adilet, which is led by the former head of Tokayev's presidential administration, won 71% of Sunday's vote, Kazakhstan's central electoral commission said, according to preliminary results.

The second-place Aul Party won 6.26% of the vote, with three other parties - the Nationwide Social Democratic Party, Respublica and Aq Jol - reaching the 5% threshold needed to win a place in parliament.

Election monitors for the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe said the vote was marred by a lack of distinct political opposition, with "all contesting parties supporting the incumbent president's policies".

Some 74% of the country's 12.6 million eligible voters took part in the election.

Congo's Ebola outbreak records one of its highest weekly death tolls yet

Most new cases in Ituri province, the current epicentre, still come from outside monitored contacts

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Bunia, August 24

More than 300 people died of Ebola in eastern Congo in the past week, one of the highest weekly tolls yet, government data showed Monday, as health workers struggle to catch up with an outbreak that is spreading at unprecedented speed.

Ministry of Health data showed that as of Saturday, the outbreak had recorded 5,514 cases and 2,642 deaths, including 317

deaths reported in the previous seven days.

But Congolese experts have said the outbreak that started weeks before it was confirmed could be three times the known size.

This is the fastest-growing Ebola outbreak in history, with many people dying outside treatment centres. It has recorded seven times more deaths at this stage than the 2014-2016 West Africa Ebola outbreak that is the deadliest in history with over 11,000 in all.



Most new cases in Ituri province, the current epicentre, still come from out-

side monitored contacts.

Nearly half of people infected have died - 47.9

per cent - but the government data shows much higher rates in hard-to-reach areas such as North Kivu province, which has a fatality rate of 68.6 per cent.

A key challenge has been the lack of approved vaccines or treatments for the rare Bundibugyo virus responsible for the outbreak.

On Friday, Congo received more than 16,000 doses of the Ervebo vaccine that was effective in past Ebola outbreaks

caused by a different, more common type.

The World Health Organisation (WHO) says it also will be used in clinical trials for a Bundibugyo virus vaccine.

WHO says it's not known whether Ervebo can protect against the Bundibugyo virus, although early laboratory and animal data suggest it may offer some protection.

Officials have not said when the vaccine will be rolled out to frontline workers.

News at a glance

TCS to acquire Porsche’s IT arm MHP for 320 mn euros

NEW DELHI: Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) on Monday said it will acquire a 100 per cent stake in Porsche AG subsidiary MHP Management- und IT-Beratung GmbH for an enterprise value of 320 million euros (approximately Rs 3,574 crore). The acquisition is part of a five-year strategic partnership with Porsche valued at 1.25 billion euros. The transaction, through TCS Netherlands BV, is expected to close in three to four months, subject to regulatory approvals. TCS CEO and MD K Krithivasan said the partnership will industrialise AI at scale for Porsche.

Airtel Payments Bank 1st qtr profit jumps 82% to ₹19 crore

NEW DELHI: Airtel Payments Bank on Monday reported an 82 per cent rise in net profit to Rs 19 crore for the first quarter ended in June, driven by good operating performance. The bank had earned a profit of Rs 10.4 crore in the April-June quarter of the previous financial year. The bank’s revenue increased to Rs 831 crore from Rs 777 crore in the corresponding quarter last financial year, Airtel Payments Bank said in a statement. During the quarter, the company’s EBITDA rose by 21 per cent to Rs 108 crore from Rs 82 crore in the same period a year ago.

SoftBank pares 2.6% stake in Lenskart for ₹2,888 crore

NEW DELHI: SoftBank Group on Monday sold nearly 2.6 per cent stake in eyewear retailer Lenskart Solutions for Rs 2,888 crore through open market transactions, reducing its holding to 7.28 per cent from 9.86 per cent. Through affiliate SVF II Lightbulb (Cayman) Ltd, SoftBank sold 4.5 crore shares in 22 tranches at an average Rs 641.75 apiece, according to BSE data. It had sold a 3.25 per cent stake for Rs 2,873 crore in June. SoftBank remains Lenskart’s second-largest public shareholder, while Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust holds 9.77 per cent.

Tata-owned IHCL announces merger of Oriental Hotels

NEW DELHI: Tata Group-owned Indian Hotels Company Ltd (IHCL) on Monday said Oriental Hotels Ltd (OHL) will be merged with IHCL through an all-stock transaction. The boards of both companies approved the Scheme of Arrangement, proposing 25 IHCL shares for every 117 OHL shares, with completion targeted for the second half of FY2028. IHCL Managing Director and CEO Puneet Chhatwal said the merger will simplify the group’s holding structure and unlock the potential of OHL’s portfolio. OHL MD and CEO Pramod Ranjan said the merger will create significant value for shareholders.

DECISION AIMED AT BOOSTING FARMERS’ INCOME

Govt lifts ban on export of wheat and its products

The government has also removed the export ban on wheat flour, maida, semolina, and wholemeal atta

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

The government on Monday lifted the export ban on wheat and its products with immediate effect and said the decision is aimed at boosting farmers’ income amid depressed domestic prices. Early this year, the government had allowed export of 50 lakh tonnes of wheat and 10 lakh tonnes of wheat products. India, the world’s second-largest wheat producer, banned wheat exports in May 2022 as part of measures to control rising domestic prices. “The export policy of wheat...is revised from prohibited to free with immediate effect,” according to notifications issued by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade. The government has also removed the export ban on wheat flour and other products such as maida, semolina, and wholemeal atta, as per other notifications. When asked about the decision, Food Secretary Sanjeev Chopra said,



FOOD SECRETARY SANJEEV CHOPRA SAID, THERE IS ADEQUATE AND BUMPER STOCK OF WHEAT AVAILABLE IN THE COUNTRY, SUFFICIENT TO MEET THE DEMAND AND CHECK PRICES

“Export ban has been lifted in the interest of farmers. The domestic wheat prices are depressed currently. Allowing exports will increase the domestic market prices and encourage good sowing in the coming rabi season, and farmers will get better prices.” On the impact of consumer prices, Chopra said there is adequate and bumper stock of wheat available in the country, sufficient to meet the demand and check prices.

The export of wheat, which was allowed earlier through issue of licence, has now been simplified, he added. Out of 60 lakh tonnes allowed earlier, 2.5 lakh tonnes have been shipped so far, the secretary said. India’s wheat production stood at a record 120.65 million tonnes in the 2025-26 crop year (July-June) as against 117.94 million tonnes in the preceding year. Food Corporation of

KEY POINTS

- » Out of 60 lakh tonnes allowed earlier, 2.5 lakh tonnes have been shipped so far, the secretary said
- » India’s wheat production stood at a record 120.65 million tonnes in the 2025-26 crop year (July-June) as against 117.94 million tonnes in the preceding year
- » According to government data, the all-India average retail prices of wheat stood at Rs 31.46 per kg on Monday, while the rate of wheat flour at Rs 37.3 per kg

India (FCI), the government’s nodal agency for procurement and distribution of foodgrains, has nearly 49 million tonnes of wheat in buffer stock. According to government data, the all-India average retail prices of wheat stood at Rs 31.46 per kg on Monday, while the rate of wheat flour at Rs 37.3 per kg. The rates of wheat and wheat flour (atta) are flat compared to the year-ago period.

No sugar shortage in India, prices to ease in coming days following govt’s measures: ISMA

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 24

Sugar industry’s apex body ISMA on Monday asserted that there is no shortage of sugar in the country and said the prices in the retail market are expected to decline in the coming days following the government’s decision to allow imports besides imposing stock holding limits on traders and bulk consumers.

On Monday, the average all-India retail prices of sugar stood at Rs 63.05 per kg, 29 per cent higher than Rs 48.73 per kg a month back. The maximum retail price on Monday stood at Rs 75 per kg, while the model price was hovering at Rs 65 per kg, according to the government data.

Addressing a press conference, Indian Sugar and Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) President Niraj Shirgaokar said the prices have risen due to various factors, including speculative buying by traders and bulk consumers as well as lower production than estimated.

“India does not have a sugar shortage. Our production and stock position remain fundamentally comfortable,” he told reporters. The country’s net sugar production (after diversion to ethanol) is estimated at around 279 lakh tonnes in the 2025-26 marketing year (October-September), while the opening stock was 50 lakh tonnes. The annual



ON MONDAY, THE AVERAGE ALL-INDIA RETAIL PRICES OF SUGAR STOOD AT RS 63.05 PER KG, 29 PER CENT HIGHER THAN RS 48.73 PER KG A MONTH BACK

domestic demand is seen at 280-285 lakh tonnes while the country exported 8 lakh tonnes of sweetener before the government imposed a ban. Shirgaokar projected the closing stock of roughly 35 lakh tonnes at the end of September. “That is a healthy buffer against normal domestic demand, even after accounting for sugar diverted to ethanol,” he added. The government’s duty-free import window, tightened stockholding limits, ongoing special crushing, and an early start to the new season would help in augmenting domestic supply and control prices, the ISMA President said. Shirgaokar pointed out that the average retail prices have risen but said the “increase is not being

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The maximum retail price on Monday stood at Rs 75 per kg, while the model price was hovering at Rs 65 per kg, according to the government data
- » ‘India does not have a sugar shortage. Our production and stock position remain fundamentally comfortable,’ ISMA President Niraj Shirgaokar said
- » India’s net sugar production (after diversion to ethanol) is estimated at around 279 lakh tonnes in the 2025-26 marketing year (Oct-Sept)

driven by any actual shortfall in availability”. He noted that the prices have started to ease following the government’s decision to allow duty-free imports of 1 million tonnes of raw sugar and also stock holding limits on dealers as well as bulk consumers. The ex-mill prices have eased in the last few days and are currently ruling at around Rs 55-56 per kg in two major sugar-producing states – Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, he said. “India’s sugar balance is fundamentally comfortable. The recent price rise reflects a combination of weather effects, festive demand, global tightening, and - most significantly - speculative stocking, rather than any real gap in supply,” he said, adding that the supply should remain

stable through the festive period. Asked about the government putting blame on industry for jacking up ex-mill prices, ISMA president categorically said that the industry was not involved in creating any artificial scarcity and increasing rates. However, he did not rule out that some mills might be holding stocks and said the government is looking into that. Shirgaokar said the mills sold 75-80 per cent of their stocks in the current marketing year at a loss, and they might achieve breakeven. Elaborating on the reason for the surge in prices, Shirgaokar said, “The rise reflects several factors coming together, not one single cause. Domestic output for the season came in below initial projections.” The gross sugar production (before diversion to ethanol) was revised to around 309 lakh tonnes from the initial estimates of 345 lakh tonnes mainly due to weather-related effects, lower cane yield and lower recovery, including a higher crush rate in Maharashtra and red-rot-related varietal issues in Uttar Pradesh, he added. Festive-season buying has also picked up, as it does every year. Globally, lower estimated sugar production in Brazil has tightened supplies & pushed global prices from around \$474/tonne in June to about \$552/tonne by August.

Govt appoints ex-diplomat Akbaruddin, 2 others to RBI central board

AGENCIES
Mumbai, August 24

The central government has appointed former diplomat Syed Akbaruddin, former bureaucrat Annie George Mathew, and Janmejaya Kumar Sinha, Chairman, BCG India, as part-time, non-official directors on the Reserve Bank of India’s Central Board. Their appointments are for four years from August 24 or until further orders, whichever is earlier, the RBI said on Monday. Last week, the government re-appointed industrialist Anand Gopal Mahindra and appointed former ISRO Chairman Somanath Sreedhara Panicker to the board. Other board members include Revathy Iyer, former Deputy Comptroller and Auditor General, and Sachin Chaturvedi, Director General, Research and Information System for Developing Countries. RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra, Deputy Governors Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta, SC Murmu and Rohit Jain, Economic Affairs Secretary Anuradha Thakur and Financial Services Secretary Sanjay Lohia are also members.

RBI’s special forex swap facility mobilises \$73 billion as of Aug 21

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 24

The Reserve Bank of India’s special USD-INR forex swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits, Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCB) and External Commercial Borrowings (ECB) has mobilised foreign exchange inflows of \$73 billion as of August 21, 2026, reflecting strong backing from Non-Resident Indians (NRIs). FCNR(B) deposits alone accounted for \$65.40 billion of the total mobilisation,

reflecting a significant response from NRIs and overseas depositors, the finance ministry said in a statement. Last week, the RBI advanced the closure of the FCNR(B) swap window by a month to August 31 as against the earlier cut-off date of September 30. The scheme started on June 8 with the objective to attract foreign capital to stem the falling rupee against the dollar. The pace of mobilisation has surpassed expectations,

with the facility attracting \$73 billion in less than 11 weeks, it said. The scale is also significantly higher than the RBI’s 2013 FCNR(B) swap scheme, which had mobilised around \$26 billion over nearly three months, it said. The strong response has prompted the RBI to advance the closure of the FCNR(B) window to August 31 from the earlier scheduled date of September 30, after the facility achieved its objective ahead of schedule, it said.

AAI posts profit of ₹6,522 crore in FY26

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, August 24

Airports Authority of India (AAI) reported a net profit of Rs 6,522.37 crore for the financial year ending March 31, 2026, marking a decline from the Rs 7,233.28 crore recorded in the previous financial year, according to the financial statements of AAI. Despite the moderation in bottom-line numbers, the overall financial footing of AAI strengthened during the period. Total reserves and surplus expanded significantly, climbing to Rs

27,890.17 crore as of March 31, 2026, compared to Rs 23,324.51 crore recorded at the end of the previous fiscal year. As per AAI, from the net profit generated during the financial year, the authority earmarked Rs 852.39 crore towards an interim dividend and recommended a final dividend payout of Rs 1,104.32 crore. In addition to shareholder returns, substantial amounts were retained to bolster capital buffers. The authority transferred Rs 1,826.26 crore into the Airport Development Reserve

and allocated another Rs 2,739.40 crore to the General Reserve. The balance in the Airport Development Reserve climbed to Rs 12,689.95 crore from Rs 10,863.69 crore in the preceding year. At the same time, the General Reserve expanded to Rs 15,181.12 crore from Rs 12,441.72 crore. On the capital and liability side, the equity capital contribution from the Government of India stayed constant at Rs 656.56 crore. Long-term borrowings contracted to Rs 2,020.03 crore at the close of the financial year from Rs 2,171.31 crore a year earlier.

Meanwhile, current maturities of long-term debt increased to Rs 388.35 crore from Rs 257.15 crore, while short-term borrowings remained nil across both comparative periods. Trade payables for goods and services stood higher at Rs 925.12 crore against Rs 664.39 crore in the prior year. Total long-term provisions reached Rs 7,795.38 crore compared to Rs 7,054.31 crore, whereas short-term provisions settled at Rs 11,196.36 crore against Rs 11,875.45 crore.

Govt to sell up to 6% stake in Hindustan Copper at ₹514/share

Shares of Hind Copper settled at ₹573.55 on BSE

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 24

The government will sell up to 6 per cent stake in Hindustan Copper Ltd (HCL) through an offer for sale (OFS) at a floor price of Rs 514 a share. The floor price is at a 10.38 per cent discount over Monday’s closing share price of Hindustan Copper on the BSE. In a post on X, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management

THE FLOOR PRICE IS AT A 10.38.% DISCOUNT OVER MONDAY’S CLOSING SHARE PRICE

(DIPAM) secretary Arunish Chawla said the Government of India offers to divest 3 per cent equity in Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL) through an Offer for Sale (OFS), with an option to divest an additional 3 per cent (green shoe) in case of

oversubscription. The OFS will open at a floor price of Rs 514 per share. Shares of Hind Copper settled at Rs 573.55, up 0.17 per cent, on the BSE on Monday. According to Chawla, 10 per cent of the offer is reserved for retail investors, with an additional 25,000 shares set aside for eligible employees. So far in the current fiscal, the government has mopped up Rs 52,716 crore through PSU disinvestment.

TRANSACTION VOLUME ROSE TO OVER 24,162 CRORE IN FY26

UPI completes 10 yrs, clocks nearly 13K-fold rise in transaction volume

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 24

Unified Payments Interface (UPI), which was launched on August 25, 2016, has completed a decade of transforming India's digital payments landscape, emerging as the backbone of the country's digital payments ecosystem and a global benchmark for real-time payments.

Annual UPI transaction volume rose from 1.78 crore in 2016-17 to more than 24,162 crore in 2025-26, an almost 13,000-fold increase, the finance ministry said in a statement.

During the same period, transaction value jumped from Rs 0.07 lakh crore to around Rs 314 lakh crore, representing a more than 4,000-fold rise, it said.

Developed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) under the regulatory oversight of the RBI, UPI has recorded an unprecedented expansion in both transaction volume and value over the past 10 years, it said.

The year 2026 marked



a significant milestone in the growth trajectory of UPI, it said, adding that monthly transaction volumes crossed 2,300 crore for the first time in May 2026, reaching 2,320 crore transactions, signalling a new scale of adoption.

This momentum continued through the year, with July 2026 recording 2,366 crore transactions, the highest monthly transaction volume in UPI's decade-long journey, it said.

UPI has witnessed a steady and broad-based expansion in institutional participation since its launch. The number of

banks live on UPI increased from 44 banks in 2016-17, the first year of operations, to 703 banks by 2025-26.

In FY26, it said, UPI transactions totalling 24,162 crore reflected the platform's deep integration into everyday digital payment usage across the country, with robust momentum in the merchant segment.

The statement noted that the UPI has emerged as a key pillar of India's digital public infrastructure, providing an interoperable, real-time platform for seamless peer-to-peer and peer-to-merchant payments through a single

KEY POINTS

» During FY17-FY26, transaction value jumped from Rs 0.07 lakh crore to around Rs 314 lakh crore, an over 4,000-fold rise

» Monthly transaction volumes crossed 2,300 crore for the first time in May 2026, reaching 2,320 crore transactions, signalling a new scale of adoption

interface.

The platform has expanded access to digital financial services, helped bridge the digital divide and strengthened financial inclusion by enabling individuals, businesses and merchants across the country to participate in the formal digital economy, it said, adding that the simultaneous growth in transaction volumes and values also reflects the deepening role of UPI in India's high-frequency retail payments ecosystem.

The scale, reliability and interoperability of UPI have drawn global recognition, with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) acknowledging it as the world's largest real-time payment system by transaction volume.

As of 2025, UPI accounted for nearly 49 per cent of global real-time payment transaction volumes, according to the IMF.

With more than 66 crore transactions processed daily, UPI has become a dominant payments network in India, reinforcing the country's position as a global leader in instant and inclusive digital payments.

What began as a domestic payments innovation has also evolved into a platform for cross-border digital transactions. UPI is currently operational in 11 countries – the UAE, France, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Singapore, Mauritius, Qatar, Cambodia, Greece and Maldives, it said.

The statement further said that the next decade of UPI is poised to drive even greater transformation in India's digital payments landscape.

SBI Research flags possible rate hike as MPC minutes turn hawkish

ANI NEWS

New Delhi, August 24

SBI Research has flagged the possibility of a rate hike by the RBI, saying the latest Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) minutes have turned more hawkish, even as Governor Sanjay Malhotra has maintained a cautious and data-dependent approach.

In its latest Ecowrap report, SBI Research said the difference between the MPC minutes, the monetary policy statement and the Governor's comments has created uncertainty for markets over the future path of interest rates.

"The latest MPC minutes appear more hawkish, keeping inflation risks and the possibility of further tightening in focus while the Governor's statement sounds considerably more patient and data-dependent," the report said.

SBI Research said the hawkish tone of the MPC minutes has strengthened in recent months. In terms of macro tones, the report said that when the Governor's statement is taken as 1, the MPC minutes increased from 1.76 in June 2026 to 1.82 in August 2026, showing a rise in hawkishness.

The divergence was

more visible on issues related to policy, interest rates, inflation and prices. The MPC minutes gave greater importance to risks that could influence future rate decisions, while the Governor focused more on growth and financial conditions.

"The policy dilemma for markets is therefore increasingly a 'chalk or cheese' problem," SBI Research said, adding that markets will have to assess whether the hawkish tone of the minutes means an October rate hike remains possible or whether the Governor's cautious approach will continue.

The report said "the window of a rate hike(s) has now opened up", although the decision remains finely balanced due to both global and domestic factors.

On the global front, SBI Research said the US economy remains resilient, supported by consumer spending and investment in artificial intelligence. However, weaker employment and high borrowing costs linked to debt could pose risks.

The report said the US Treasury's decision to double buyback operations for longer-dated securities to USD 4 billion per operation

from September 9 could help ease pressure on long-term yields.

A US Federal Reserve rate cut in September appears unlikely, noting that a bond buyback programme and a rate hike would be difficult to pursue together. It added that higher crude oil prices and geopolitical tensions could keep inflation risks elevated.

Domestically, uneven monsoon conditions remain a concern. The nationwide rainfall deficit was around 13 per cent, while several major foodgrain-producing states, including Bihar, Andhra Pradesh, Punjab and Karnataka, continued to face significant deficits. Of 741 districts, 351 had received deficit or large-deficit rainfall.

The report said Skymet had lowered its 2026 monsoon forecast to 85 per cent of the Long Period Average, with a 70 per cent probability of drought, while El Nino conditions had become firmly established.

SBI Research projected August CPI inflation at 4.7 per cent and said inflation could rise above 6 per cent in October and November before easing to around 5 per cent in the fourth quarter of FY27.

Briefs

Rupee rises by 1 paisa to 95.70/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee settled with a marginal gain of 1 paisa at 95.70 against the US dollar on Monday, supported by the inflow of foreign funds in domestic equities.

At interbank forex, the rupee opened at 95.65 & traded in range of 95.64-95.75. It finally settled for the day at 95.70 against the greenback, higher by 1 paisa from its previous close.

Gold touches 5-month high of ₹1.64L/10g

NEW DELHI: Gold prices climbed to over five-month high of Rs 1,64,400/10 grams on Monday, tracking firm global trends & renewed demand amid escalating US-Iran tensions.

Silver also advanced for the third session in row, rising by Rs 3,500 to over a four-month high of Rs 2,53,500/kg.

In the global markets, spot gold gained \$42.45, or 1 per cent, to \$4,646.54 per ounce and silver traded flat at \$69 per ounce.

Sebi to introduce IT Resilience Index for mkt infra institutions

AGENCIES

New Delhi, August 24

Markets regulator Sebi has introduced an IT Resilience Index (ITRI) to assess the functioning and resilience of information technology systems of market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges, depositories and clearing corporations.

The move aims to strengthen oversight, identify emerging weaknesses early and enable timely corrective action. The ITRI will be computed using nine parameters, with availability and security carrying the highest weightage of 20 per cent each. Integrity,



governance, reliability and monitoring, business continuity, and modularity and flexibility will carry 10 per cent each, while scalability and other aspects, including incident handling, will account for 5 per cent each.

MIIs will develop an Early Warning System to detect deterioration in ITRI parameters that could lead to performance issues or

disruptions. The framework, including real-time service monitoring, will be operationalised by February 28, 2027. The first computation will cover the half-year ended March 31, 2027.

The index will be computed half-yearly through a system-driven process, with comparative analysis submitted to technology committees and governing boards.

Separately, Sebi aligned its Incident Reporting Portal with the Financial Stability Board's Format for Incident Reporting Exchange framework to streamline cyber-incident reporting.

India needs human-centric eco model: Experts

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 24

India needs to move beyond the conventional binary of capitalism and socialism and develop a human-centric economic framework combining enterprise and innovation with social justice, fiscal responsibility, decentralisation and ecological sustainability, speakers said at MANTRANA, the flagship discussion series of Bharat Ki Soch, held with the Dattopant Thengadi Foundation at the India International Centre.

Opening the dialogue, Anil Rajput, Chairperson,



Bharat Ki Soch, said, "The task is not to choose an ideology of the past, but to design institutions for the future. We need markets, because prosperity cannot be commanded. We need the State, because markets alone cannot ensure justice or sustainability. And we need a moral framework,

because neither can define a good society alone."

The day-long discussion brought together former Planning Commission member Arun Maira; Virjesh Upadhyay, Director General, Dattopant Thengadi Foundation; Prof. Deepak Nayyar, former Chief Economic Adviser;

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, August 24

Benchmark equity indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Monday as persistent geopolitical tensions and elevated crude oil prices hampered risk appetite.

Despite a positive beginning, the 30-share BSE Sensex failed to carry forward the momentum and declined 171.72 points, or 0.22 per cent, to settle at 77,369.11.

The 50-share NSE Nifty slipped 32.95 points, or 0.14 per cent, to end at 24,219.05.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Adani Ports, Bharat



Electronics, Bajaj Finance, Bajaj Finserv, Trent, Axis Bank, State Bank of India, and TCS were among the laggards. Tata Steel, HCL Tech, Infosys, and Hindustan Unilever were among the major winners.



Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, dropped 1.68 per cent to \$92.80 per barrel.

I-T dept asks non-audit taxpayers to file ITR before Aug 31 deadline

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, August 24

The income tax department on Monday nudged taxpayers with business or professional income who are not subject to audit to file ITRs for AY27 before August 31.

Till August 20, over 2 crore ITR 3 and 4 were filed on the e-filing portal, taking the total Income Tax returns filed for AY27 to over 6.5 crore. This also includes over 5.9 crore ITR-1 and ITR-2, which were filed by the due date



of July 31.

"31st August 2026 is the due date for filing ITRs for AY 2026-27 for taxpayers with business or professional income who are not subject to audit. Be the tax hero who files on time," the I-T department said on X.

If a taxpayer falls in non-

audit category, he/she can file the applicable ITR (ITR-3, ITR-4, ITR-5 or ITR-7).

ITR-3 is filed by individuals and Hindu Undivided Families (HUFs) with income from a proprietary business or profession.

ITR-4 is simpler form that cater to small and medium taxpayers. ITR-5 is filed by firms and Limited Liability Partnership and Cooperative Societies. ITR-6 is filed by companies registered under Companies Act and ITR-7 by trusts and charitable institutions.

Aditya Birla Health unveils insurance solutions for ICAI

It will cover over 12.32 lakh CA students

MPOST BUREAU

Mumbai, August 24

Aditya Birla Health Insurance Co. Ltd. (ABHICL), the health insurance arm of Aditya Birla Capital, has partnered with the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) to expand access to health insurance across the accounting fraternity.

Under the initiative, ABHICL will offer tailored health insurance solutions

to over 12.32 lakh CA students and more than 4.67 lakh CA members, along with exclusive health insurance and wellness benefits for professionals associated with CA firms.

The portfolio includes Activ Yuva for individuals below 35 years, Activ One Max Unlimited Care with Durable Equipment Rider for those above 35 without chronic conditions, and Activ One VYTL for individuals with pre-exist-

ing diseases.

Policyholders can also access wellness benefits and earn HealthReturns of up to 100 per cent of their annual premium by achieving prescribed health goals.

Mayank Bathwal, CEO, Aditya Birla Health Insurance, said the association aims to make quality healthcare protection more accessible while encouraging healthier lifestyles.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



NBCC & HUDCO CMDs Dr. K P Mahadevaswamy & Sanjay Kulshreshtha, respectively, along with Dr. Suman Kumar, Director (Commercial), NBCC; M Nagaraj, Director (Corporate Planning), HUDCO; and Daljeet Singh Khatri, Director (Finance), HUDCO, at the Bhoomi Pujan ceremony marking the commencement of two major development projects in Delhi-NCR.



NTPC Ltd launched its three-month Vigilance Awareness Campaign 2026 at Scope Complex, New Delhi. Rashmita Jha, IRS, Chief Vigilance Officer (CVO), inaugurated the campaign, which will be conducted from August 17 to November 16, 2026 as a prelude to the Vigilance Awareness Week 2026. The CVO also unveiled the revamped Corporate Vigilance Intranet page.



The SEBI-NSE Investor Awareness Pavilion inaugurated by, Shri Shripad Yesso Naik, Hon'ble Union Minister of State in the Ministry of Power; and Minister of State in the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, Government of India in presence of Shri Vikas Sukhwil, CGM, RD, WRO, SEBI; Shri Naveen Sharma, CGM, SEBI; along with SEBI Officials, NSE officials

GOVT. OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
DEPARTMENT OF MATERIALS MANAGEMENT (P-II)
SHER I KASHMIR INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, SOURA
SRINAGAR KASHMIR, J&K
Tel. 0194-2401013/2400064 (Ext:2170) Fax: 2403403 email: ammopurchase2@skims.ac.in (2nd Extension)

Subject: Extension of e-NIT
Reference: e-NIT No. SIMS 05 (P-II) of 2026 dated 15.07.2026 (Tender Id: 2026_SKIMS_316298_1).
The schedule for submission & opening of tenders in respect of the above referred eNIT for supply of Fogging Solution & Surface Disinfectant at SKIMS Soura Srinagar is hereby extended, as per following:

Description	Schedule
Last date & time for submission of online bids	29.08.2026 (02:00PM)
Date & Time for opening of Technical Commercial bids	31.08.2026 (02:00 PM)

Sd/- Materials Management Officer
Purchase-2nd
No. SIMS 325/73/2025-8200-08 Dated: 20/08/2026
DIPK-NB-1473/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Arun @ Happy** S/o Shri Yogesh Kumar R/o H. No. A-211, J.J. Colony, Pankha Road, Uttam Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 737/2016 u/s 498A/406/34 IPC & 4 DP Act at P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Arun @ Happy** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Arun @ Happy** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. /84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arun @ Happy** accused of FIR No. 737/2016 u/s 498A/406/34 IPC & 4 DP Act at P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **23.09.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Rishika Srivastava,
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court-01) (North-East)
Room No. 67, 4th Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/1899/NE/2026

आरखण्ड सरकार
पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, गुमला
(दूरभाष - 08524-223092, (फोन) 9431708376, E-mail Id- sp-gumla@jhpolice.gov.in)

(Search for Missing Person)



Details of the missing person:- Name:-Anju Kumari, Age 17 years, & Current age: 29, Height: Approx. 100 cm, Weight: Approx. 34 kg, Hair: Long and Black, Eyes: Normal, Complexion: Wheatish, Build: Thin, Clothing: White Shirt and Red Skirt.

It is hereby informed to the general public that the victim, Miss Anju Kumari, daughter of Innocious Ekka, resident of Village Farsiyatoli, P.S.+District-Gumla (Jharkhand), was last seen in Delhi in 2014 at the age of 17. In connection with this, a General Diary entry No. 10/19 dated 27.07.19 has been lodged at P.S. Ahtu and the search is ongoing. Public cooperation is requested for her search. It is necessary to make the above information public. Therefore, all members of the public are requested.

if anyone has any information about the above missing girl, regarding Anju Kumari her identification or whereabouts, please contact the Office of the Superintendent of Police, Gumla, or any of the following numbers:

1. Superintendent of Police, Gumla - 9431706376
2. Deputy Superintendent of Police (HQ), Gumla - 9471182113
3. Sub-Divisional Officer, Gumla - 9431706202
4. Officer-in-Charge, AHTU P.S., Gumla - 8986604506, 8809624441

Sd/- Superintendent of Police Gumla
POLICE HELPLINE (EMERGENCY DIAL)-112 CHILD HELPLINE-1098
WOMEN HELPLINE-1091
PR.NO.388281 Police Wireless Headquarter(26-27):D

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 723 Date: 24/08/2026
e-TENDER NOTICE
Office of the (Executive Engineer (E&M), MB-II, Joshiyara Barrage, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No.08/EE(E&M)/MB-II/Barrage/2026-27
Name of work/supply/services etc. Annual Routine Maintenance of Electro Mechanical and Hydro Mechanical Equipment's of barrage including sweeping and cleaning for the year 2026-27
Estimated cost : Rs 40,04,286.00 Only + GST Extra
Date of availability of bid document on website: 25.08.2026, 16:00 hrs
Last date for submission of bids on website: 16.09.2026, 11:30 hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in" (Executive Engineer)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Sr. DEE/EMU/GZB for and on behalf of President of India, Invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

Sr	Name of work	Estimated in Rs.	Cost in Rs.	Starting Date for download-ing bid	EMD	Time Allowed	Deadline for submission of Bid.
1	Tender Notice No. RT1-232-Elect-EMU-WC-08-25-26						
2	Name Complete Electrical & Mechanical Overhauling of Hydraulic Lifting of the Platform for 4/8 Wheeler Tower Wagon at EMU Car Shed, Ghaziabad work for the period of 03 Years.						
3	Tender cost	NIL					
4	Approximate Cost	Rs. 82,63,665.55 inclusive of GST					
5	Earnest Money	Rs. 1,65,300.00 (payment mode available on IREPS website)					
6	Completion period	36 Months					
7	Validity of offer	60 days					
8	Date & Time from tender advertised on IREPS website	22.08.2026 12:50 Hrs.					
9	Date & Time from tender submission start and end	31.08.2026 to 14.09.2026 15:00 hrs.					
10	Tender closing Date & Time	14.09.2026 15:00 Hrs.					
11	Date & Time of tender Opening (immediately when tender submission ends)	14.09.2026 15:00 Hrs.					

Note 1: All participant Tenderer/Tenderers will submit their requisite documents along with their tender offer. "No post tender correspondence for submission of additional document shall be entertained after opening of the technical & commercial offer. Even suo-moto post tender letters of the tenders shall be treated as null & void". **Note 2:** Duplicate documents should not be enclosed/up loaded. Tender Notice is available on website of www.ireps.gov.in.
RT1-232-Elect-EMU-WC-08-25-26 Date: 22.08.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2931/26

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Shimla Urban Division, HPPWD, Shimla-3 on behalf of Governor of HP invites the percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system, from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD, for the work as detailed in the table.

Sr No	Name of work	Estimated in Rs.	Cost in Rs.	Starting Date for download-ing bid	EMD	Time Allowed	Deadline for submission of Bid.
1	Additional alteration of HPPSC Office building at Nigam Vihar, Shimla-02/394. C/o of work-ing area near Canteen of HPPSC Building, Nigam Vihar, Shimla-02.	Rs. 5016644.00		24-08-2026	Rs.100340.00	Rs.2000.00	One Month 01-09-2026
2	Repair / renovation to vari-ous residential buildings under Division no.-III, Shimla (SH- Repair of WC/bath , Kitchen P/L, cupboards, flooring work, painting and distemping & IVS and SI in set No. block 2, set no.6 at Richmond under Benmore Sub Division)	Rs. 393078.00		24-08-2026	Rs.7870.00	Rs. 350.00	One Month 01-09-2026

The bidders are advised to note other details, of tenders from the department website, www.hptenders.gov.in. The Executive Engineer reserves the right to accept/reject any tender/application without assigning any reason.

Ro.No 2883/2026-2027 "HIM SUCHANA AWAM JAN SAMPARK"

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli
E-Advertised Tender Notice No.29 ET/2026 Dated: 19.08.2026

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	05261180	Design, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of one coach Set of Inter Vehicular Coupler assemblies	122 Set	17.09.2026
		Design, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of One Coach Set of Inter Vehicular Coupler Assemblies for Multiple Unit (MU)	14 Set	
		Design, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of One Coach Set of Inter Vehicular Coupler	14 Set	
		Design, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of one coach set of Inter Vehicular Coupler assemblies for Multiple Unit (MU)	121 Set	
02	15255233A	Supply, Installation, Commissioning & proving out of Magnetic	1 Nos	01.09.2026
		Total cost of Comprehensive AMC for Five years After Expiry of warranty period of Two years.	1 Nos	
03	05261276A	Stainless Steel Battery Box	206 Nos	08.09.2026
04	12261161	Anti Role Bar Fork	5259 Nos	14.09.2026
05	05261255	Supply, Installation, Testing and commissioning of GPS based Public Address & Passenger Informatin system (PAPIS) and LED destination Board-	91 Set	15.09.2026
		Supply, Installation, Testing and commissioning of GPS based Public Address & Passenger Informatin system (PAPIS) and LED destination Board-	13 Set	
		Supply, Installation, Testing and commissioning of GPS based Public Address & Passenger Informatin system (PAPIS) and LED destination Board-	14 Set	
06	03261598	Supply and Installation of AC Duct for LACCN Amrit Coaches	72 Set	18.09.2026
		Supply and Installation of AC Duct Arrangement for LACCN Amrit	24 Set	

Corrigendum

Tender Notice No.	Tender No.	Due date may be read as
ET/2026 Dated: 03.07.2026	04251366B	27/08/2026
Tender Notice No. 26	04261116	31/08/2026
ET/2026 Dated: 07.08.2026	04261116	19/08/2026
Tender Notice No. 27	03261140	25/08/2026
ET/2026 Dated: 11.08.2026	03261140	18/08/2026
Tender Notice No. 26	15265147	01/09/2026
ET/2026 Dated: 07.08.2026	15265147	18/08/2026

Website Address: www.ireps.gov.in & www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in Dy.CMM/Electrical

Corrigendum No. 1, Date-21/08/2026

Corrigendum	Tender no. CAMC- Paint- 26-27-202	Closing date of the tender may be read as
		31.08.2026 instead of 24.08.2026.

Website: www.ireps.gov.in Dy.CME/M&P

Open tender based on single packet system Tender Notice No.: MCF/RBL/ Tender/Calibration of Instruments/ 2026-27 & 2027-28/C699 dt. 18.08.2026 (Tender No. MCFRBL69918082026) is invited by Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/SMS & HK, MCF/RBL, through IREPS portal www.ireps.gov.in for and on behalf of president of India for the following work:-
Description of work : Calibration of various Measuring Instruments & Gauges of various shops for 02 years as per Scope of Work., **Approx. Value (₹) :** ₹ 8,94,305.83, **Cost of Tender document (₹) :** Zero, **EMD - 17,900.00, Quantity of work-** As listed in Bill of Quantities, **Completion period of work-** 24 months., **Date & time of closing of Tender-** 10.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs., **Detailed Tender Notice, Terms & conditions** are available at IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in in tender document.

Dy. CME/SMS & HK

SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
No. SG-664-12-Sig-2026-27

E-TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDERMENTIONED WORK.

Sl.No.1, Name of the work: Details:
Provision of Aspiration type automatic fire detection and alarm system (AFDAS) for the section of DSTE/DHN, DSTE/KQR, ASTE/DHN & ASTE/GMO in DHN Div.

2. Approx Cost of the work:
Rs. 7,62,26,879.06 (Approx). **3. Earnest Money :** Rs. 15,54,500.00. **4. Date & time for closing of tender:** 08.09.2026 at 12:30 Hrs., **5. Any E-Tenders** which is sent by Post/Courier/FAX or self, Manual proposals although the letter is on firms letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Note:- Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 10 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.

Sr. D.S.T.E
East Central Railway, Dhanbad
PR/0783/DHN/S&T/7/26-27/36

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sukhbir
Civil Judge (Junior Division) Bhiwani
State Bank of India
Vs.
Ravinder
CS -1134-2024
CNR No. : HRBH02-001737-2024
Next Date 17-09-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
RAVINDER
Son of Simbhu
Village Titani, Tehsil and District Bhiwani
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 17-09-2026 at 10:00 am. For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=Bhiwani
Sd/- Sh. Sukhbir
Civil Judge (junior Division)
Dated 17.08.2026 Bhiwani

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) PROJECT DIVISION- III, JAMMU
SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. 43 of 2026-2027 Dated 22-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State / Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time Allowed for completeon	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of
1	Upgradation of Govt. Qtr. by way of tiling, woodwork and other allied works at Channihimmat flats Jammu. CNo-120 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	14.40	600	2% of Advertised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	A, B, C & D
2	Upgradation of Qtr. No. 3 Block 8 Channihimmat (Door windows change, Bathroom repair, washbasin, sanitary fittings, electrical fitting (replacement), tiles in room. CNo-121 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	2.88	600	2% of Advertised Cost	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	A, B, C & D
3	Upgradation of Flat No 8-12 Pocket 4 sector 2 Channihimmat (Housing Board Flats). CNo-122 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	1.92	600	2% of Advertised Cost	15 Days	((1300 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	"A, B, C & D
4	Upgradation of Government Qtr. No.14-C, 20-C, 21-C& 39-C at Gandhi Nagar, Jammu by way of construction of additional room and other allied works. CNo-123 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	33.60	600	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	A & B
5	Upgradation of Govt Qtr. no. 5 B at Gandhi Nagar Jammu. CNo-124 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	8.64	600	2% of Advertised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 29-08-2026	A, B, C & D

Position of AAA : Accorded
Position of TS : Under Process
The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website <http://ktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting
4	Bid submission Start Date
5	Bid Submission End Date
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids

No :- PWD(R&B)/PD-III/5579-91
Dated : 22-08-2026
DIP No:DIP/1-8695/26

Sd/- (Er. Rahat Gupta)
Executive Engineer
Project Division III Jammu

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
SHER-I-KASHMIR INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
SOURA, SRINAGAR, J&K (INDIA)-190011
E-Mail: anmoimports@skims.ac.in Fax: 0194-2403403

NOTICE

Subject: Procurement of Consumables for BD Bactec™ MGIT™ 960 System.

SKIMS intends to procure the following consumables from M/s Becton, Dickinson and Company, being their proprietary items as claimed by the respective companies:

Sr. No.	Nomenclature
1.	BD BBL™ MGIT™ Mycobacteria Growth Indicator Tubes, 7ml
2.	BD BACTEC™ MGIT™ 960 Supplement kit
3.	MycPrep kit
4.	BD BACTEC™ MGIT™960 SIRE KIT
5.	BD MGIT™ TBc Identification Test

In this connection, objections (if any) from companies manufacturing / marketing such type of items compatible to BD Bactec™ MGIT™ 960 System installed in the department of Microbiology and capable of delivering the same result, regarding the proprietary nature should be communicated within 10 days on the above mentioned e-mail id after which the claim of the company who has claimed for the proprietorship of the item shall be accepted.

No: SIMS 324-16-2026-Lab- 1352-26
Dated: 19/08/2026.

DIP No:DIPK-NB-1475/26

Materials Management Officer
Imports SKIMS.

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 728 Date: 24/08/2026
e-TENDER NOTICE
The office of Executive Engineer (Generation), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No: NIT-26/EE(GEN)/MB-II/2026-27
Name of work / Supply/Services: Enhancement of Storage Capacity of CCTV Surveillance System at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.
Estimated cost: Rs. 15,88,700/- Only + GST extra respectively
Date of availability of bid document on website: -25.08.2026
Last date for submission of Bids- 16.09.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"
Executive Engineer (Generation)
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
SUCCESSION CASE
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Annu
Judicial Magistrate - Ist Class,
CHARKHI DADRI
Ramesh chand and others
Vs.
Smt. Saraswati and others
CNR No. HRCDO2-000451-2024
Next Date:- 14-09-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
17. URMILA DAUGHTER OF CHANDRAWALI ALIAS CHANDERAWATI DAUGHTER OF DHANNA SON OF DUNGAR RESIDENT OF- CHARKHIYO WALI DHANI, NEAR BANSIL PARK, AZAD NAGAR, BHIWANI
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 14-09-2026 at 10:00 am. For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=CharkhiDadri
Sd/- Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin.
Dated 21.08.2026 Narwana

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Annu
Judicial Magistrate - Ist Class
Dated 21.08.2026 Charkhi Dadri

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused (1) Shalini Bhatia (2) Vijay Kumar Bhatia Partner & Authorised Signatory R/o B-239, Sector-1, D.S.I.I.D.C. Industrial Area, Bawana, New Delhi-110039 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in CC NI ACT 2004/2021 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Bawana, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused (1) Shalini Bhatia (2) Vijay Kumar Bhatia cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) Shalini Bhatia (2) Vijay Kumar Bhatia has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that (1) Shalini Bhatia (2) Vijay Kumar Bhatia in CC NI ACT 2004/2021 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Bawana, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 25.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Akash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-3
North, Room No. 213
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11828/ON/2026

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006,
Telephons: 0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Ref. No.: 724 Date: 24.08.2026
e-Tender Notice
The office of Executive Engineer (E&M), Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:-
e-Tender No. 07/EE(E&M)/VB/2026-27
Name of work: Supply, Installation, Testing & commissioning of Electric submersible agitator slurry & sand pump & dewatering pump including hose pipe, cable & their DOL control panel at Virbhadra Barrage, Rishikesh.
Estimated cost : Rs 85,47,540/- GST Extra
Date of availability of bid document on website: 25/08/2026 from 17:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 15/09/2026 Up to 17:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in> Executive Engineer (E&M) Pashulok Barrage
"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity" -Rishikesh

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Persons namely 1.Sanjay, 2.Laxman Dass, 3. Rahul S/o Laxman Dass, 4. Geeta D/o Laxman Dass, 5. Meenakshi W/o Sanjay, 6. Nikhil S/o Laxman Dass, 7. Mayank S/o Anil Kumar, R/o: 16-B, Aram Bagh, Govt. Quarters, Paharganj, New Delhi (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 87/2017, U/s 377/506/498A/406/34 IPC Act , registered at P.S.: Pandav Nagar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused Sanjay, Laxman Dass, Rahul, Geeta, Meenakshi, Nikhil & Mayank cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Sanjay, Laxman Dass, Rahul, Geeta, Meenakshi, Nikhil & Mayank have absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Sanjay, Laxman Dass, Rahul, Geeta, Meenakshi, Nikhil & Mayank accused FIR No. 87/2017, U/s 377/506/498A/406/34 IPC Act , registered at P.S.: Pandav Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 25.09.2026.

By Order
Ms. Ritika Kansal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
(Mahila Court-2), Court No. 24, East Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11878/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mohit Singh @ Tuti @ Prince, R/o Near Geeta Bhawan Chowk, Ganda Nala, Chhajja Wala Mohalla, Kot Ka Pura, Faridkot, Punjab has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.195/2020 u/s 25 Arms Act, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Mohit Singh @ Tuti @ Prince cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mohit Singh @ Tuti @ Prince has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Mohit Singh @ Tuti @ Prince of FIR No.195/2020 u/s 25 Arms Act, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 15.12.2026.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
(Central District), Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11834/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person (1) Ankit Negi, S/o: Sh. Sohan Singh, R/o: H.No. 3/201, Dakshinipuri, New Delhi (2) Aslam, S/o: Md. Khalil, R/o: H.No. 3/131, Dakshinipuri, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in SC No. 639/2025, FIR No: 453/2025, U/s: 323/308 IPC 115(2)/110, 118(1)/126(2)/351(2) (5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Ambedkar Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) Ankit Negi (2) Aslam, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) Ankit Negi (2) Aslam, has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person (1) Ankit Negi (2) Aslam, of SC No. 639/2025, FIR No: 453/2025, U/s: 323/308 IPC 115(2)/110, 118(1)/126(2)/351(2) (5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Ambedkar Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 05.10.2026.

By Order
Samar Vishal
Additional Session Judge-02(South)
Court No. 303,
Saket District Court, New Delhi

DP/10655/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) Raju Kumar @ Praveen S/o Seeta Ram R/o B-109-112, Vijay Nagar, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Dwarka, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case FIR No. 303/2019, U/s 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Punjabi Bagh, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Raju Kumar @ Praveen can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Raju Kumar @ Praveen has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) Raju Kumar @ Praveen of Case FIR No. 303/2019, U/s 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Punjabi Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 28.11.2026.

By Order
Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court-01), Room No. 358
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/11806/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED



General public is hereby informed that this Women (depicted in the photo) namely Khushi W/o G.K. Lal R/o Jhuggi No. C-208, Bhim Nagar, Sabzi Mandi, Jawal Puri, Delhi has been missing / kidnapped from his residence since 05.08.2026

DHRUV'S HUNDRED GIVES INDIA COMMAND OVER SL IN 2ND TEST

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, August 24

An unflappable Dhruv Jurel allayed concerns surrounding his form with a remarkably composed unbeaten 115 before bowlers struck early blows to give India command of the second Test against Sri Lanka on a rain-hit second day here on Monday.

Jurel's second Test hundred powered India to a hefty 503 for nine declared in their first innings, and Sri Lanka were reduced to 8 for two at close after pacer Prasidh Krishna and Manav Suthar gave marching orders to Lahiru Udara and Prabath Jayasuriya respectively.

Kamil Mishara was batting on five when the stumps were drawn at 5.51 pm of an extended session. The hosts are trailing by 495 runs.

But the main story-line of the day was given by Jurel, fresh from his 51 in the first innings of the opening Test last week.

If the fifty at Galle broke a barren run of eight innings, Jurel underscored his growing confidence and touch with a near flawless knock at the SSC ground.

India gained immensely from his innings, and the right-hander was also involved in two vital stands



Shubman Gill bats at nets on the eve of the second Test against Sri Lanka

– a 112 for the seventh wicket with Rishabh Pant that lifted India from 307 for six to 419.

For the subsequent wicket, Jurel and Manav Suthar added 39 runs that helped the tourists to further break away from their opponents and close in on the 500-run mark.

However, Jurel's consistency was the key ingredient in both those partnerships. The 25-year-

old's 177-ball innings was a prime example of risk-free runs accumulation and situational awareness.

At the beginning of the day, Jurel gave full support to Pant, who came out to bat after the early dismissal of debutant Saransh Jain.

At that time, the focus was on Pant because he had to retire on 3 after coping a blow on his forearm by Lahiru Kumara on Sunday. Jurel understood the

circumstances, and gave more strike to Pant, who played a typical innings of 63, full of chutzpah.

Pant fought gallantly against Lankan pacers during his near two-hour stay at the crease, batting with confidence and little discomfort.

The eventual runs against his name might have looked good, but Pant had to dig deep to reach that mark. Pacers

IN SHORT

» If the fifty at Galle broke a barren run of eight innings, Jurel underscored his growing confidence and touch with a near flawless knock at the SSC ground

» India gained immensely from his innings, and the right-hander was also involved in two vital stands — a 112 for the seventh wicket with Rishabh Pant that lifted India from 307 for six to 419

Fernando and Kumara targeted his body with a bouncer barrage, and the former even managed to ping on his shoulder once.

However, Pant was equal to the task, either moving away from the line or nudging the ball around.

There was an explosive moment too, when the left-hander got inside the line to hook Kumara over fine leg for a six. Pant, who made a 66 in the second innings at Galle, reached his fifty in 81 balls with a pulled four off off-spinner Keshara Nuwantha.

Tears, heartbreak as India's wait for WC medal goes on

'Nerves cost us against Australia, but proud of team'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 24

Tears flowed freely in the Indian camp after the women's hockey team's hopes of making the World Cup semi-finals ended in heartbreak, following a goalless draw against Australia here on Sunday.

As the final hooter sounded, veteran goalkeeper Savita Punia and Bichoo Devi, sitting in the dugout, broke down.

Ishika Chaudhary, playing her maiden World Cup, sat behind them, staring blankly as the enormity of the missed opportunity sank in.

For a team that had dared to dream and looked capable of turning that dream into India's first medal in women Hockey WC, the campaign ended with tears and heartbreak.

India finished level on points with Australia but were eliminated from semifinal contention on goal difference.

The disappointment was visible on the faces of the players as they walked off the field, many of them red-eyed and struggling to hold back tears before



India, Australia played out a goalless draw on Sunday

INDIA ENDED LEVEL ON POINTS WITH AUSTRALIA BUT WERE ELIMINATED FROM SEMI-FINAL CONTENTION

boarding the team bus.

For a side featuring 11 players at their first World Cup, the exit was particularly difficult to digest.

Head coach Sjoerd Marijne, who spoke to the media after the match, too could not hide his disappointment, while scientific advisor and head of athlete performance Wayne Lombard and senior players tried to lift the spirits

of the younger members of the squad. One player, sitting on the stairs and speaking to her mother over the phone, summed up the mood in the camp.

"This was the best opportunity. We came so close, and now I don't know when I'll get this chance again," she said.

Savita, playing in her third World Cup, was equally heartbroken.

"This was the best opportunity," the player with 318 caps said quietly.

Experienced midfielder Neha Goyal was inconsolable. When reminded of next mission of winning gold at the Asian Games, she could only nod silently.

Argentina put India out of misery

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 24

India's men's hockey team failed to overcome the pressure of conceding an early goal and saw its hopes of reaching the World Cup semifinals end

with a 3-5 loss to Argentina here on Monday.

After losing to the Netherlands in their previous match, India were almost out of the race for the last four from Pool E. However, Argentina's victory over England had tech-

nically kept their qualification hopes alive. India needed to win by at least three goals to advance, but conceded twice in the opening six minutes and struggled to recover. With this defeat, India remained fourth in the pool.

Worlds rewind: Open season in men's singles

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 24

Men's singles has entered an unusually open phase, with a deepening pool of contenders making sustained dominance increasingly difficult to imagine, according to several leading players, including new World Badminton champion Alex Lanier of France and world No. 7 Victor Lai.

The evidence is not just in the names at the top of the rankings but in the uncertainty surrounding almost every major tournament. The gap between the established elite and the chasing pack has nar-



rowed considerably, while the physical demands of the modern men's game have made consistency across an entire season increasingly difficult.

"It's a tough question, but I definitely feel that

“IT IS BECOMING INCREASINGLY DIFFICULT IN MEN'S SINGLES TO WIN ONE TOURNAMENT AND THEN WIN ANOTHER ONE THE FOLLOWING WEEK

this is a different period," said Lanier when asked whether it is possible to achieve the kind of domination that the old guards such as Lee Chong Wei, Lin Dan or Viktor Axelsen once achieved.

Partners in time? Jurel hails 'terrific' Pant I seek his advice, says Jurel



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, August 24

Dhruv Jurel's Instagram bio is simple yet catchy. It reads Mamba Mentality — a term coined by basketball legend Kobe Bryant to describe his efforts to become the best version of himself.

Jurel's unbeaten 115 on the second day of the second Test against Sri Lanka here on Monday was a testimony of his devotion to that motto.

At one end, Rishabh Pant, with whom he built a 112-run stand, was playing in his archetypal way for 63, but Jurel concentrated on his strengths to accumulate runs.

Jurel explained his batting methods while batting alongside a sparkling shot-maker like Pant.

"We all know Pant is such a terrific player and what he has done for India in Australia and England. So, whenever he is in, I only seek his advice, because he has so much experience. So, I always

ask him for advice as, what I should do in a particular situation," Jurel said in the post-day press conference and dedicated his second Test hundred to his parents.

But does he get tempted to copy the dominating ways of Pant?

"As you can see, Test cricket has different ways of playing, and it makes the game beautiful. When you play with Pant, it's a very terrific experience. I can't play like him, the way he has been playing since childhood. My game plan is to see which bowler should I take down, which spell should I play, and I always ask Pant because he is a wicketkeeper, I am a wicketkeeper, and we play in the middle order, so it's a very good experience.

The wicketkeeper batter also offered a fitness update on Pant, who did not do the stumper's duty towards the end of the day.

"Right now, he got a hit on his right shoulder, and we are closely monitoring him."

Gauff readies for US Open with Cincinnati crown

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Mason, August 24

Coco Gauff defeated fellow American Jessica Pegula, 6-2, 6-4, to capture her second women's Cincinnati Open title, and Arthur Fils of France defeated American Frances Tiafoe 6-3, 1-6, 6-0, in the men's final for his first Masters 1000 title.

In Saturday's semifinals, Pegula beat defending champion Iga Swiatek and Gauff defeated Sara Bejlek to set up the first all-American women's final at the Cincinnati Open in 56 years.

Torres announces PSG arrival in style; Barcelona win big, Salah shines

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Madrid, August 24

Ferran Torres scored twice in his Paris Saint-Germain debut to help the French defending champion draw 2-2 at Rennes in its league opener, while Barcelona began their defence of the Spanish league title in style with a 5-0 rout of Elche.

Manchester City left it late to win in their first Premier League match under Enzo Maresca and Mohamed Salah scored his first goals for Turkish club Trabzonspor.

Julian Alvarez heard boos from the Atletico Madrid crowd in his return to action in the Spanish league after asking to leave



The last time two American women played in the Cincinnati final was in 1970, when Rosie Casals beat Nancy Richey.

Pegula's best finish in Cincinnati came in 2024, when she lost to Aryna Sabalenka in the final.



the club, and both Juventus and AC Milan won in the Italian league.

Torres' dream start Torres, who joined PSG from Barcelona after scoring Spain's World Cup winning goal last month, came off the bench to score in

the 71st and 82nd minutes, helping his new club avoid a second consecutive loss after a penalty shootout loss to Lens in the French Super Cup.

Both goals were assisted by Torres' Spain teammate Fabian Ruiz.

Indian Overseas Bank

Branch : Punjabi Bagh, 1/52, North Avenue Road,
Punjabi Bagh (W), New Delhi 110026
Tel.: 8925950687 Email : iob0687@iob.bank.in

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (SARFAESI Act) read with Rule 3(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 (Rules)

1. Whereas the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of Indian Overseas Bank under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a Demand Notice dated 30.07.2026 under Section 13(2) of the said Act. The loan accounts have been classified as a Non-Performing Asset (NPA) on 28.07.2026 as per the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) guidelines and directives. The bank hereby calls upon the Borrowers listed hereunder (hereinafter referred to as the "said Borrowers"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the Notice, within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice, as per the details given below.
2. The said Notices have been returned undelivered by the postal authorities / have not been duly acknowledged by the borrowers. "Hence the Bank by way of abundant caution is effecting this publication of the demand notice. The undersigned has, therefore, caused these Notices to be pasted on the premises of the last known addresses of the said Borrowers as per the said Act. Copies of the said Notices are available with the undersigned and the said Borrowers, may, if they so desire, collect the said copies from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.
3. Against the above background, Notice is hereby given, once again, to said Borrowers to pay to Indian Overseas Bank, within 60 days from the date of publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated/payable as given below under the loan & other documents. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been Hypothecated to Indian Overseas Bank by the respective party/ies as below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrowers with address/es	Description of Secured Assets
01	M/S TAIGAI SPORTS ENTERPRISES MR. AGYAPAL SINGH (PROPRIETOR) PLOT NO- G-213 SECOND FLOOR SECTOR-63, DIST- GAUTAM BUDHNAGAR, NOIDA, UP 201301	A. Stocks of footwear materials and Book Debts B. Machineries details as- 1. Frame stretching 4 frame – 1 Number 2. Exposure machine – 1 Number 3. Frame oven – 1 Number 4. Raise printing table 65x4 feet- 1 Number 5. Automatic dryer - 1 Number 6. Electrical Busbar 65 Feet- 1 Number 7. Stoppers -150 Numbers 8. 2002 drum type sole press machine -2 Numbers 9. High frequency welding Embossing machine -12KW -1 Number 10. Air compressor 5HP 3 Phase -2 Numbers 11. Heating Chamber with NIR Systems -2 Numbers 12. 38 Heat Press Machine (15"x15")- 1 Number 13. Hot Melt Roller Coater (12inch)- 2 Numbers 14. 834-2 Hot Melt Spray Machine (Double Station)- 1 Number
02	MR. AGYAPAL SINGH (PROPRIETOR OF M/S TAIGAI SPORTS ENTERPRISES) S/O LAKHVINDERPAL SINGH, H NO 1, NAKODER ROAD, OPPOSITE T.V. TOWER, TOWER ENCLAVE PHASE-3, KURALA, JALANDHAR, PUNJAB 144003	
03	MR. AGYAPAL SINGH (PROPRIETOR OF M/S TAIGAI SPORTS ENTERPRISES) S/O LAKHVINDERPAL SINGH, KH NO-995, KHASRA NO 1629/4 41-5, KHEWAT NO. 524/460, BAHADUR GARH, MIE PART -B, BAHADURGARH, JHAJJAR, HARYANA 124507	
04	MR. AGYAPAL SINGH (PROPRIETOR OF M/S TAIGAI SPORTS ENTERPRISES) S/O LAKHVINDERPAL SINGH, HNO 776/1/1, UDHYOG NAGAR, FIRNI ROAD, MUNDKA, WEST DELHI, NEW DELHI 110041	
05	MR. AGYAPAL SINGH (PROPRIETOR OF M/S TAIGAI SPORTS ENTERPRISES) S/O LAKHVINDERPAL SINGH, HNO-1101 TOWER 2, TATA NEW HAVEN, BAHADURGARH, JHAJJAR HARYANA 124507	

Sl No.	Nature of facility	Limit (Rs. in Lacs)	Total dues* as on 30.07.2026 (In Rs.)
1.	Cash Credit	100.00	Rs 1,02,01,285.95 (Rupees One Crore Two Lakh One Thousand Two Hundred Eighty-Five and Paise Ninety-Five only)
2.	Term Loan	11.63	Rs 7,74,609.92 (Rupees Seven Lakh Seventy-Four Thousand Six Hundred Nine and Paise Ninety -Two Only)
	Total	111.63	Rs 1,09,75,895.87 (Rupees One Crore Nine Lakh Seventy-Five Thousand Eight Hundred Ninety-Five and Paise Eighty-Seven Only)

* Payable with further interest at contractual rates/rests as agreed from the date mentioned above till date of payment.
4. If the said borrowers fail to make payment to Indian Overseas Bank as aforesaid, then Indian Overseas Bank shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act and Rules entirely at the risks, costs and consequences of the said borrowers.
5. Further, the attention of borrowers is invited to provisions of Sub-section(8) of the Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to them to redeem the secured assets.
6. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the SARFAESI Act from transferring the secured assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of Indian Overseas Bank. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules shall be liable for imprisonment and/ or fine as given under Section 29 of the Act.

Date: 24.08.2026
Place: New Delhi
Sd/-
Authorised Officer
Indian Overseas Bank

1.	Open Tender No.	ELS-SRE-T-52RTI
2.	Name of work	Complete body cleaning, cyclonic filters cleaning in 3-phase locomotive at Electric Loco Shed Saharanpur for period of eighteen months.
3.	Date of Closing/Opening	18.09.2026
4.	Approx. Cost	Rs. 18.85,113/-
5.	Earnest Money	Rs.37,700/-
6.	Completion period	18 (Eighteen) Months
7.	Validity period	60 days
8.	Cost of tender form	"Free of cost" for downloading from IREPS & Tenderers should have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate to participate in E-Tendering of Works Tenders 2. Tenderer are required to upload self-attested scanned copies of all related eligibility documents as per conditions 3. Taxes & Charges will be applicable as per extant rule. 4. For details, please log on IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in

E- TENDER NOTICE No. ELS-SRE-T-52RTI Dt. 22/08/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

2929/26

'DHURANDHAR WASN'T AN EASY FILM TO MOUNT'

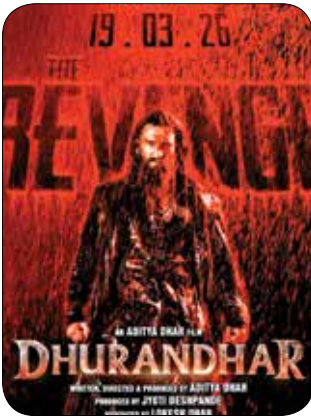
Bollywood actor Ranveer Singh recalled his tough phase before the film saga's arrival



In Reliance's documentary film 'Parvah Hai Toh Parivar Hai', Ranveer Singh acknowledged the abundant love and appreciation showered by audiences on the 'Dhurandhar' franchise, expressing his gratitude to the Ambani family for placing their trust in the makers and backing the project. The actor said that the Ambani family showed faith in him and supported him at a time when he was having a rough phase in his career. "Dhurandhar" wasn't an easy film to mount; it wasn't an easy film to execute. There were several challenges. Danke ke chot pe ja ke back karna conviction ke saath, that if this works out, we will be breaking new ground," he shared.

Ranveer added, "I have to say I was given all the love, all the support and all the encouragement, even at a time when my movies were not doing well. Career hai, ups and downs hote rehte hain. But to have received that kind of support meant a lot to me. It's nothing short of a blessing, an honour and a privilege to be associated with the Ambani family."

Singh also praised Reliance Foundation Founder and Chairperson Nita Ambani for her vision and initiatives



'IT'S NOTHING SHORT OF A BLESSING, AN HONOUR AND A PRIVILEGE TO BE ASSOCIATED WITH THE AMBANI FAMILY,' HE SAYS

aimed at taking India's heritage, talent and achievements to the world. "We all know what position they occupy, and with that position comes great responsibility. And their contribution in that regard is incomparable. They create sports, entertainment, arts and culture, education and philanthropy. The way they highlight our culture on a global stage, especially Neeta Bhabhi, is with genuine pride and genuine passion." AGENCIES



CELEBRATE THE FLAVOURS OF ONAM WITH 'THE HARVEST TABLE'

Enjoy the season of abundance & togetherness with an authentic culinary journey

MPOST
New Delhi, August 24

This Onam, Sheraton New Delhi invites guests to celebrate the spirit of Kerala's harvest festival with 'The Harvest Table' at 'Dakshin'. Happening till August 26, the specially curated festive menu brings together the authentic flavours and cherished traditions of an Onam feast.

Guests can indulge in a traditional vegetarian spread, featuring an array of regional delicacies thoughtfully prepared by Dakshin's chefs. The experience is available for -

Lunch: 12:30 pm - 2:45 pm

Dinner: 7 pm - 11:45 pm

SHERATON NEW DELHI'S 'DAKSHIN' BRINGS TOGETHER THE AUTHENTIC FLAVOURS AND CHERISHED TRADITIONS OF AN ONAM FEAST

Price: Rs 3,500 + taxes per person (Vegetarian)

Celebrate the season of abundance and togetherness with an authentic culinary journey that captures the essence of Onam, served with warmth and hospitality.

For reservations, please contact +91 9650520153

Actress and mimicry artist Aasha Singh Jaiswal dies

The late actress played the role of Kripa in 'Mahabharat', the twin sister of sage Kripacharya

NEW DELHI: Veteran character actress Aasha Singh Jaiswal, known for her roles in 'Mahabharat', 'Baaazigar' and 'Bobby Jasoos', died at the age of 83.

Jaiswal, who was also a mimicry artist, died on August 22 in Mumbai. Her last rites were performed on Sunday, her son Akkash Bharadwaj shared in a social media post.

"She was a hard-working woman, an iron lady. I request all of you to pray for the peace and salvation of her soul. I also request you to find her work on social media or wherever

JAISWAL WAS ALSO KNOWN FOR HER ROLES IN 'BAAZIGAR' AND 'BOBBY JASOOS'



you can and watch it so that her soul, wherever it may be, finds comfort in knowing that she is still remembered through her work," Bharadwaj wrote on 'Instagram'.

Jaiswal worked on several television shows and films. She played the role of Kripa in 'Mahabharat', the twin sister of sage Kripacharya who married Dronacharya. PTI

'MAHAKALI' TRAILER



AKSHAYE KHANNA IS UNRECOGNISABLE AS GURU SHUKRACHARYA

The official trailer of Akshaye Khanna starrer 'Mahakali' has been released by the makers. The actor's first look as Shukracharya was unveiled last week, creating a lot of buzz on social media. After playing 'the king of Lyari' Rehman Dakait in Aditya Dhar's Dhurandhar, Akshaye will be essaying the role of the Guru of the Asuras (demons) in the upcoming mythological action-adventure drama. In the trailer, Akshaye looks almost unrecognisable in a long white beard, matted hair and traditional outfit. The video, titled

IN THE TRAILER, AKSHAYE APPEARED ALMOST UNRECOGNISABLE IN A LONG WHITE BEARD, MATTED HAIR AND TRADITIONAL OUTFIT

#Shukracharya's WarCry, opened with a powerful battle between Dharma and Adharma.

In the trailer, Khanna looks almost unrecognisable in a long white beard, matted hair and traditional outfit. AGENCIES

WHICH ROMANCE TROPE ARE YOU?

We all have that one romance trope we will happily watch over and over again

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 24

We all have that one romance trope we will happily watch over and over again. Maybe that unfolds over one unforgettable summer. Maybe you prefer your romance with a little more chaos, complete with forbidden feelings, complicated triangles and impossible choices. Or perhaps fake dating and friends-to-lovers are more your speed. From summer romances and love triangles to fake relationships, forbidden love and friendships that turn into something more, this watchlist has a romance for every kind of romantic.

The Last Sunrise (Summer Love)



Some romances are meant to last forever, while others are meant to make one summer unforgettable. 'The Last Sunrise' follows college stu-

dent Ry, who heads to Mallorca with her mother and unexpectedly falls for Julian, finding herself living more in the moment as the two grow closer. With family secrets and Ry's worsening health threatening to cut their time short, their summer romance is one where every moment together counts.

Sterling Point (Love Triangle)



One girl, two possibilities and plenty of reasons to keep changing your mind. When 17-year-old Annie unexpectedly inherits a remote Canadian island from the grandfather she was never allowed to meet, she sets out to uncover the truth about her family. Along the way, she finds herself caught between Ellis and Rory, with plenty of chemistry and romantic tension making the choice anything but simple. 'Sterling Point' brings all the indecision, emotional twists and will-they-won't-they tension that make love trian-

FROM SUMMER ROMANCES AND LOVE TRIANGLES TO FAKE RELATIONSHIPS, FORBIDDEN LOVE AND FRIENDSHIPS THAT TURN INTO SOMETHING MORE, THIS WATCHLIST HAS A ROMANCE FOR EVERY KIND OF ROMANTIC

gles so addictive. Pick your side, but don't be surprised if you change it.

Off Campus (Fake Dating) The arrangement is simple. Date each other, convince everyone it's real and don't catch feelings. At Briar University, hockey-hating music student Hannah and hockey star player Garrett strike a deal to help each other out, only for their unlikely



arrangement to bring their very different worlds closer together. 'Off Campus' takes one of romance's most reliable formulas and gives us the best part, watching a perfectly practical plan become increasingly personal.

Your Fault: London (Forbidden Romance)



Nothing makes romance more irresistible than knowing it shouldn't happen. Noah and Nick's relationship is already complicated, but 'Your Fault: London' pushes them into even murkier territory. As Noah leaves for Oxford and Nick remains in London for work, distance, new people and jealousy begin to test their relationship. Staying apart may seem like a sensible choice. But when has sensible ever made for a great love story?

Every Year After (Friends to Lovers)

They know each other's stories, habits and probably



every embarrassing phase. Percy and Sam first grow close over summers spent together in Barry's Bay, before their friendship turns into first love and eventually heartbreak. When Percy returns a decade later, she is forced to face Sam and everything they left unresolved, making 'Every Year After' one for anyone who believes the best romances can begin as friendships, especially when the feelings have been there for years.

So, what is your type? A fleeting summer romance, a messy love triangle, a fake relationship that gets a little too real, a love that was never supposed to happen or the friend who was always more than a friend? Which-ever trope gets you every time, there is a romance waiting for you to stream on 'Prime Video'.